Home Network & Media Wall Plan

Revised Oct 23, 2026 · @emma · version 43 (revision 37: a bar built in beside the dining cabinet, more storage, your black shelf 10 cm off the boxing, the lamp's cap, the lights in Views, Extras lined up), drawn to your measurements

What changed: the C-table at the sofa's open end is in the plan (section 2), your window sill's plants as you have them, and four new options to look at (section 12).

1 · The plan on a page



Drawn to your measurements, in Card Room Green.

£4,382–8,260
the whole plan, item by item in section 11; no electrician on top

92 of 126
fit checks pass outright; 22 are tight, 12 need a check on site (section 3)

291 · 6
LPs (191 in the wall, 100 in your vinyl stand) · seats at the table, the chairs kept inside it

Area	Decision
Alcove	The TV in line with the sofa between two oak uprights, the right one a corner post against the breast; on the left, the turntable on the worktop and the Series X on a shelf at 134; below, three 60 cm bays: the LP crates and a slim column of game and pad drawers under the turntable, then the PlayStations with the sub and the Xbox consoles under the TV.
Side wall	One oak run from the corner: a 7 cm ledge with four more LPs that sweeps out into the PC's shelf above the sofa's open end, a smart colour strip underneath, clear of the TV's sightlines.
Dining	The compact dining cabinet under your shelf by the stairs: two oak boxes, 147.2 long and 23.4 deep, with the table and your six grey padded folding chairs inside. The table swings down and opens to 185 × 90, six in comfort; packed away it's two plain oak doors. The chimney breast keeps a “now playing” ledge and two framed LPs. It's the only table now: the long sliding cabinet and the flip-top are set aside (appendix). A more compact version, an 80-wide table, makes it 10 shorter but keeps four chairs inside, not six (section 5): your call.
Records and games	About 291 LPs: 191 in the wall, every one face-out (180 in the LP crates, 8 on the two ledges, 3 on the “now playing” ledge), and 100 in your vinyl stand (50 face-out on top, 50 spine-up between its wires). Games: about 92 face-out or spine-up in the game drawers, and 32 PS1 games in the plinth drawer.
Heights	Worktop and table 76 · TV centre 116.5 · Series X shelf 134 · ledges and PC shelf 155.4 · high shelf 196, 39 under the 235 ceiling.
Colour and light	Card Room Green No. 79, colour-drenched. The ceiling LED strip, smart colour strips in the uprights and under the side run, a bias light, and two Wolston-style spot bars with smart colour bulbs on your two existing ceiling points; one app, one scene for the lot.
Power and network	Your own job: the side-wall socket becomes a double, left for the 10-gang (everything modern, the PC included), right for the retro set, switched at the wall. Deco A in bedroom 3, Cat6 down the airing cupboard.

What it costs, piece by piece

Piece	Things to buy	About
The media wall	15	£1,177–2,202
The side wall and the PC	7	£95–210
The dining cabinet	10	£1,026–1,735
The chimney breast	3	£100–195
Lighting	5	£288–795
Paint	2	£220–540
Network	4	£111–190
Electrics (your own job)	3	£70–145
Power and cables	5	£65–115
TV, consoles and AV	7	£288–420
Vinyl kit	4	£80–190
Your picks	6	£401–552
Finishing touches	2	£13–26
Can wait (after you move in)	3	£440–930
Other	1	£8–15
All of it	**77**	**£4,382–8,260**

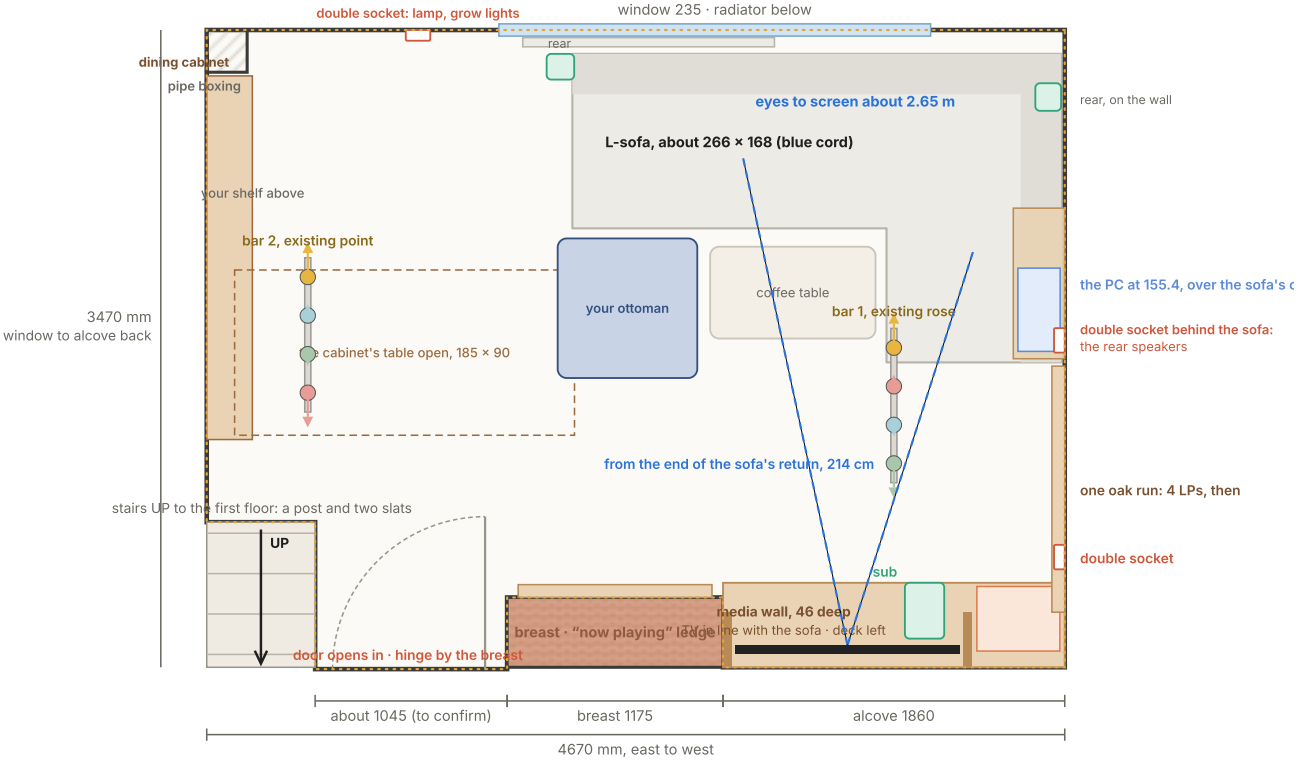
Every item, piece by piece, is in section 11's cost overview; the buy list there ticks them off.

2 · The room

Everything is drawn from your hand-measured sketch; where the agent's floor plan disagrees, your tape wins. The L-sofa is from your photo[24]: about 266 long, the return a typical 168 until you measure it, an ottoman end towards the TV, 13 cm off the window wall.

The living room from above, as you measured it

To scale, north at the top. Media wall in the alcove, one oak run on the side wall over the sofa, the dining cabinet under your shelf by the stairs, two spot bars



Ceiling 2350 mm. Sofa from your notes (long side to 40 cm short of the window's end; return 168 assumed). Both spot bars run from the TV towards the window.



The whole room in 3D, from above the window side, the dining cabinet packed away by the stairs.

From your sketch	mm	Notes
Room, east to west along the window	4670	The media wall is the south wall, shared with the hall and garage
Window wall to the alcove's back wall	3470	To the chimney breast's face: 3090
Ceiling	2350	
TV alcove, east wall to the breast	1860 × 380	Floor to ceiling
Chimney breast	1175	Projects 380 on the alcove side, 390 on the west side: the dining wall
Window and radiator (north wall)	2350 · 1370	Window starts 730 from the east wall; radiator ends 130 inside its west end; the glass from 880 to 2120 up, set 220 back in its reveal over a deep sill (from your note; the depth is drawn, please check it)
Skirting	60 × 20	White now; Card Room Green eggshell in the plan
West end: recess, door, stair box	935 / 1045 / 660 / 820	Drawn roughly: please confirm which is which
Stairs, beside the door	820 wide	They go **up** to the first floor, rising away from the room; on the room side a low white wall with your banister above it, from your photo: a square post at the foot and two flat slats up to the wall by the door[85]

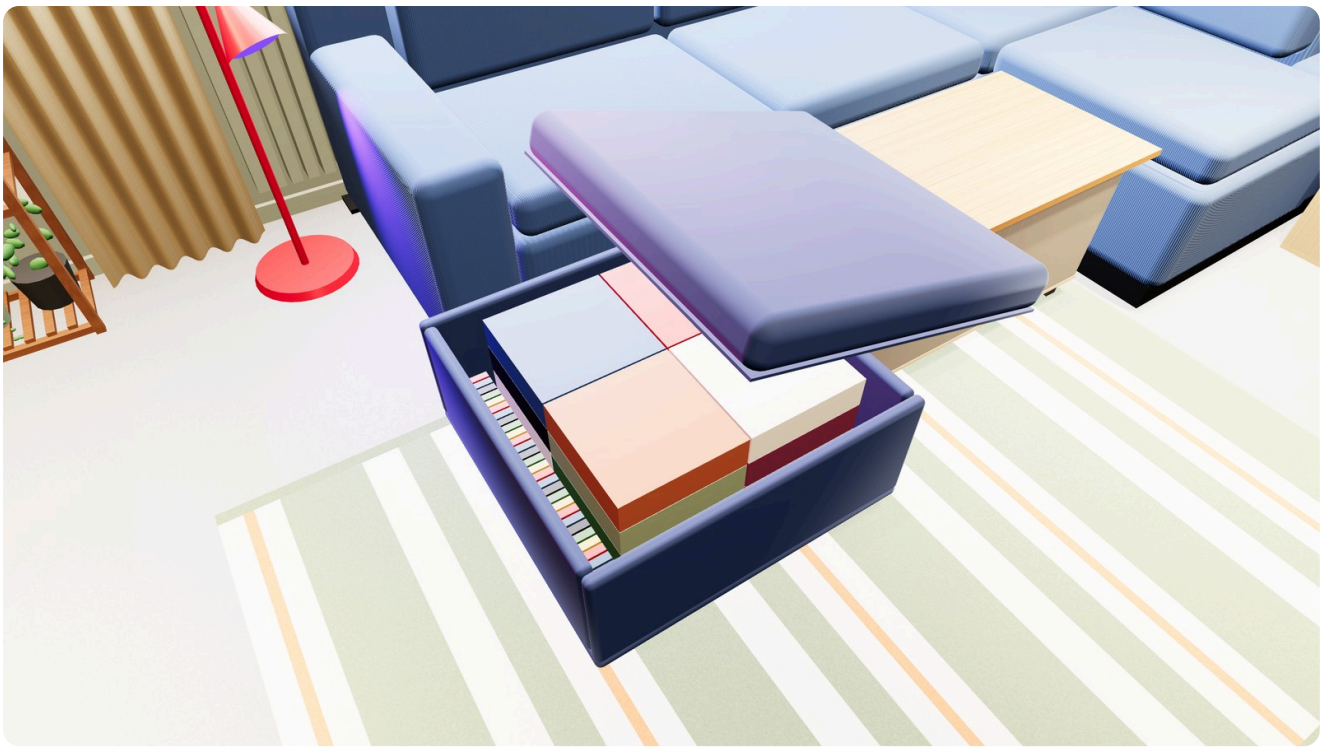
From the sofa: from the middle of the long side your eyes are about 2.65 m from the screen, which a 55-inch fills at about 26°: right for TV and games. It's about 4° off-centre; the screen's centre is just above a seated eye line. The lowest spot shade is at 212.6 cm.

Your new storage ottoman

Yours is 75 square and 44 high, in blue cord[42]. No navy cord storage ottoman is made that size[71], so the plan's is navy velvet.

- **Our pick: ISTOOLS Large Velvet Storage Ottoman, 76 × 76, navy**[68]. It's the nearest size made to yours (1 cm wider each way), with a padded lid that lifts off, a box inside for your games and cards, and a wooden frame on short legs. They don't publish its height (we've drawn 45) and the price varies by size and colour (about £300 at 76): check both on the listing before ordering.
- **Smaller and cheaper: Dunelm Square Opulent Velvet Storage Footstool, navy**, 62 × 62 × 39, 18 deep inside, £139–199[69]. It gives 14 cm back each way.
- **Bigger: Dunelm Zoe Pinstripe Square Storage Footstool**, 96 × 96 × 49, navy, £99.50–199[70]. It's a coffee-table size, and too big for the gap beside your coffee table.

Your games and cards in it. Inside it is about 70 square and 28 deep (as drawn; check the real one when it comes). Square board games come in a 30 × 30 × 8 box (Ticket to Ride's, the usual size[72]), so **12 fit**: two by two, three layers deep. A 10 cm strip along one side takes about 38 card decks on edge[73].



The storage ottoman where yours stands, beside the coffee table, its padded lid lifted.

The storage you picked

What	Where	Size
Shelf over the hall door, two lidded boxes[77]	Over the architrave (check its height)	91 × 27 at 206; boxes 35 × 26 × 15
Two lidded boxes on your black shelf[77]	Either side of the laser	35 × 26 × 15 each
Two oak alcove shelves[96]	The window corner, over the plant stand	two 90 × 23, tops at 182 and 212
Two wall cabinets, glass doors[95]	The side wall over the sofa's corner, past the PC shelf	two 35 cubes, 162 to 197 up
Drawers in the bottom three steps[101]	The stairs by the door	fronts 51 × 14.5, 35 deep
Blanket basket, water hyacinth[79]	Against the side wall at the sofa's open end	51 × 29 × 59: five throws folded long[74] stack 42.5 of its 57

Fix the wall cabinets and the shelves into plugs in the solid wall, anti-tip as the makers say. The step drawers are a joiner's job: each tread needs a bearer once its riser is cut, so build them with the new stairs.



The step drawers, pulled out.

The record table

Your coffee table's 90 × 50, from two IKEA KALLAX[80] on their backs: two bins of LPs, spine-up, about 80 in each. An oak lid lifts on a piano hinge along the TV side; it rolls on castors. 48.5 high.



Lid up: about 160 LPs in two bins.

- **Buy:** two KALLAX 42 × 42 (£19 each)[80]; an 18 mm oak board, 60 × 120[81]; 12 mm ply[82]; four 50 mm castors, 50 kg each[83]; a piano hinge cut to 83[49]; two lid stays[84].
- **Make:** build both KALLAX and screw them together side by side. Screw the ply (84 × 41) to the open backs; a castor 4 in from each corner.

- **The lid:** the oak cut to 90 × 50, corners rounded, oiled; hinged to the TV side's top edge, 3.5 over each end; a stay each end, stopping at about 80°.
- **Check:** loaded, about 65 kg; the castors take 200. The records stand on the ply, not the KALLAX shelves.

The C-table

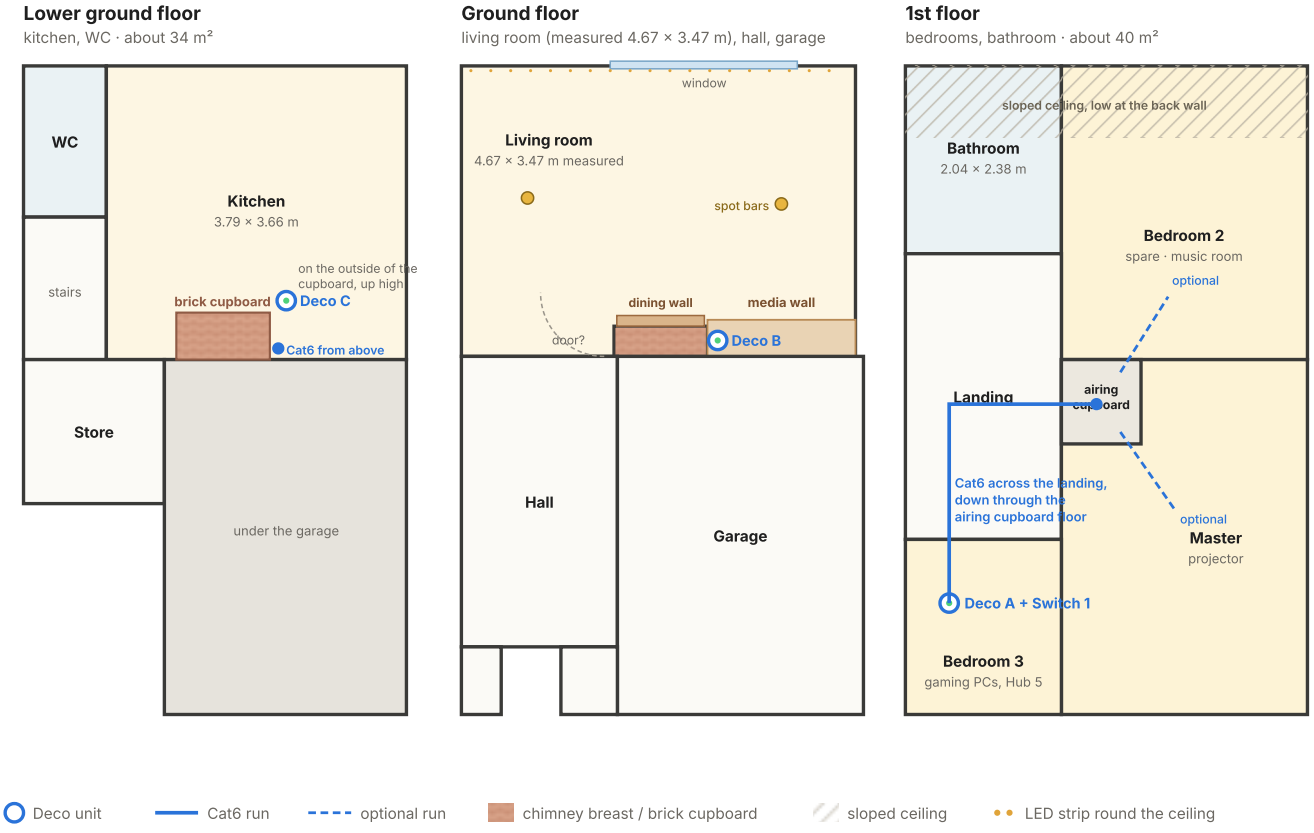
At the sofa's open end: an oak top 45 × 30 at 62, reaching 12 over the seat. Your sofa sits on the floor, so no foot can slide under it as a bought one's does[109]; a 6 mm steel plate[107] weighs its foot down instead. It holds about 12.1 kg on its far edge[108]. About £8–15.

- **Cut:** from the Snowdon pack's second 18 mm board[81]: the top 45 × 30, the upright 45 × 57.5, the foot 45 × 21.
- **Make:** glue and screw the upright to the top's and the foot's outer edges (three 40 mm screws each, plugged); round the corners; hardwax oil. Screw the plate under the foot, felt under the plate.
- **Check:** it stands square; with a full mug on the far edge it doesn't rock.

The house

The house: where the Decos and Cat6 runs go

Deco A and Switch 1 move to bedroom 3 with the Hub 5. Both Cat6 runs drop through the airing cupboard, right over the media wall's corner



Deco unit · Cat6 run · optional run · chimney breast / brick cupboard · sloped ceiling · LED strip round the ceiling

Outline traced from the agent's plan (north, the window side, at the top). The living room's alcove, chimney breast and windows are placed from your measurements.

Deco A and Switch 1 sit with the Hub 5 and the gaming PCs in bedroom 3; both Cat6 runs go across the landing and drop through the airing cupboard, which sits over the alcove's corner (section 9).

3 · The media wall



Numbered view: the game drawer and the lower LP crate are pulled out 30 cm.

OAK JOINERY	
1	Solid oak uprights, 4.5 × 30, worktop to ceiling (159 long)
2	The right upright is a corner post against the breast
3	Flush wedged tenons carry the Series X shelf (134)
4	High shelf, top 196: books up to 30 cm
5	Record ledge above the TV: 4 LPs face-out
6	The oak run wraps the corner: 4 more LPs face-out
7	LED groove in each upright: a smart colour strip washes the wall
8	High shelf, over the turntable: a small framed sleeve
ON THE WORKTOP	
9	LG OLED C6 55in · centre 116.5 high, 118.25 from the side wall
10	Soundbar · eARC, optical and AUX inputs
11	Turntable (AT-LP120X size allowed) · lid clear to 130
12	Xbox Series X on its fan stand · 15 cm air each side
13	Phono preamp, hung under the shelf at the back
14	Solid oak worktop 186 × 46 × 3, top at 76
IN THE ALCOVE BASE	
15	Oak face frame; its bottom rail hides the 9 cm plinth
16	Xbox One + HDMI switch · its brick flat at the back
17	Xbox 360 + RetroTINK · its brick flat at the back
18	Game drawer: 2 face-out bins, spine-up rows behind
19	PS3 + controller basket · bay 2 top row
20	PS2 · bay 2, beside the sub
21	PS1 · under the PS2
22	Upper record tray: an LP crate, ~90 face-out, under the turntable
23	Lower LP crate: the same, shown pulled out
24	Slim drawer: pads and remotes, a charging lead
25	Two slim game drawers: ~22 games each, face-out
26	Hidden slim drawer in the plinth, finger pull
27	Sub · bay 2, under the TV, on an isolation riser

THE CHIMNEY BREAST (THE TABLE IS BY THE STAIRS)	
28	“Now playing” oak ledge: what's on and the next two
29	Two framed LPs above
THE SIDE WALL	
30	PC on the oak run, above the sofa's open end
31	Brush grommet: the PC's leads drop into the wall
32	Pad charging dock
33	PC cables chased into the wall: no spine, no trunking
34	Keyboard tray under the shelf, rolls out
POWER, NETWORK AND LIGHT	
35	Deco B: leads in the groove behind the right upright
36	Double socket: its right switch is the retro switch
37	10-gang extension, hidden behind the TV
38	LED strip round the ceiling edge (as now)
39	Smart spot bar on the existing rose, TV to window
40	Second smart spot bar, existing point by the door
41	Stairs UP to the first floor, beside the door (direction to confirm)

Built to your alcove: 186 wide, 38 deep, 235 to the ceiling

- **Base:** 3 cm filler, three 60 cm bays, 3 cm filler. Bays 1 and 2 are IKEA BESTÅ 60×40×64 frames on a 9 cm plinth (tops at 73, back panels off); bay 3 is an 18 mm ply carcass 60 × 40 × 73 from the floor, split by

a 12 mm divider into the slim game column (two face-out game drawers and the pads drawer) and the LP column (two face-out LP crates) under the turntable. One oak face frame runs across all three; its bottom rail hides the plinth and a hidden drawer under bay 2 with a finger pull (no push-to-open at floor level).

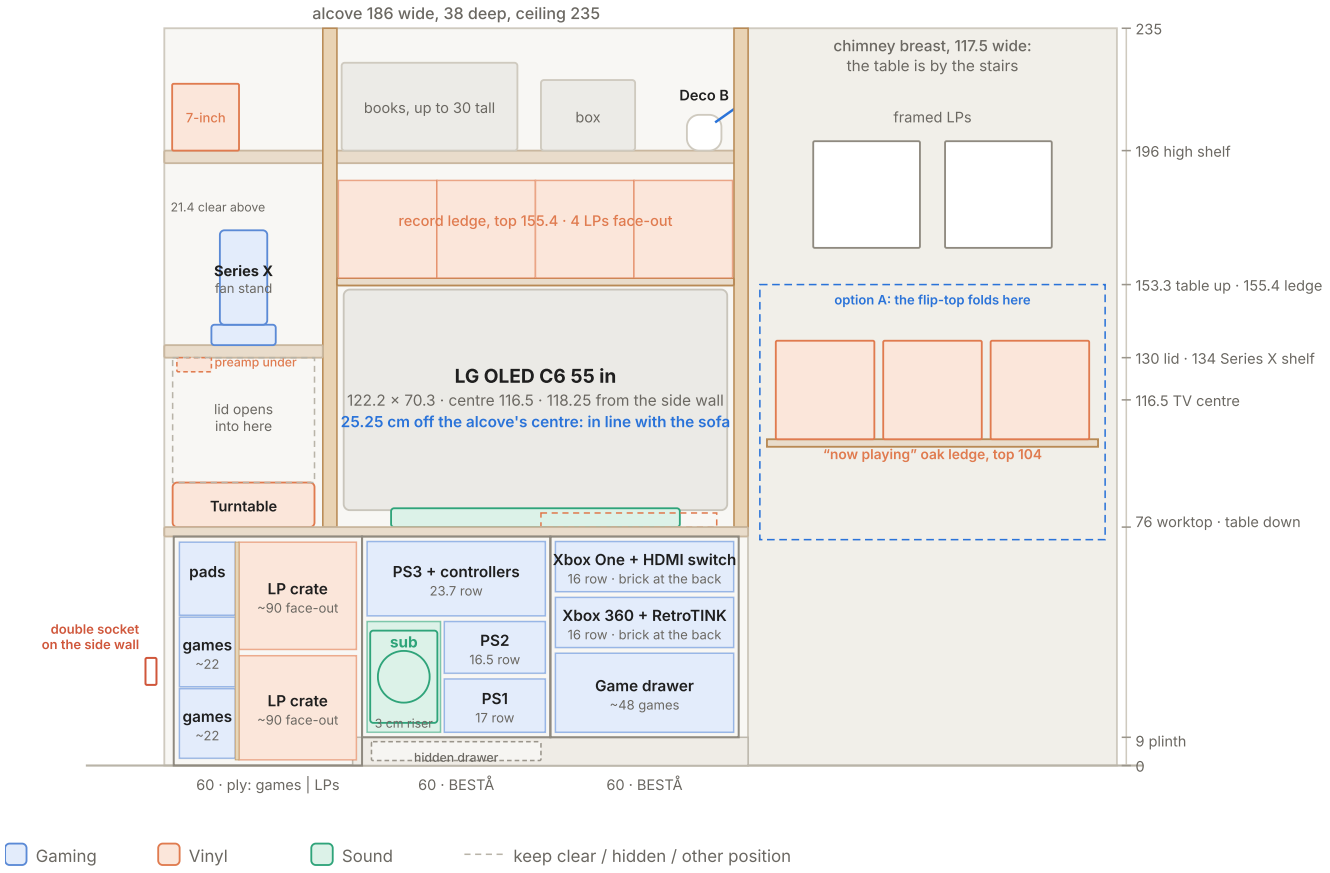
- **Depth:** 40 cm frames, a 4 cm cable channel behind and the 2 cm face frame make 46 cm from the back wall, 8 cm proud of the chimney breast.
- **Worktop:** solid oak, 186 × 46 × 3, top at 76, with a brush-lined slot behind the TV and a grommet behind the deck.
- **Oak uprights:** 4.5 × 30 cm, 159 cm from the worktop to the ceiling. The left one is at 50.5–55, between the turntable zone and the TV. The right one stands against the breast at 181.5–186, a corner post that frames the TV. That leaves 126.5 cm between them, 2.15 cm clear of the TV each side.
- **TV:** centre 118.25 cm from the side wall, in line with the sofa, on LG's stand set 2 cm off the back wall: bottom 81.4, centre 116.5, top 151.7. The soundbar sits centred under it at the worktop's front edge.
- **The turntable zone:** 50.5 cm between the side wall and the left upright. The deck sits on the worktop with 2.65 cm each side and its lid opens to about 121. Above it is an oak shelf at 134, through-tenoned into the upright, carrying the Series X on its fan stand; the phono preamp hangs underneath at the back.
- **Shelves above:** the record ledge at 155.4 between the uprights, four LPs face-out; the high shelf at 196, wall to wall in two lengths, with books, a box, a print, a small framed sleeve and Deco B.
- **Bay 2 with the sub:** the PS3 keeps the top row. Below its shelf the bay splits: on the left the sub's column, 23.4 cm wide, then a 12 mm ply divider, then 32.2 cm for the PS2 over the PS1 on a part shelf. The sub stands on a 3 cm isolation riser with 1 cm each side and 2.9 above. Its front is flush with the face frame, so its driver faces the room and its rear port has 15.6 cm to the wall.
- **Power:** the side-wall socket in front of the records bay becomes a double. Its two leads enter through a notch at the left end of the face frame's bottom rail and run back through the plinth to the channel.

The media wall, looked over again

- **The TV's remote:** the soundbar's top is 0.6 above the screen's bottom edge, right where LG puts the remote's receiver. Sit the bar 2 cm proud of the stand's foot so the beam from the sofa clears it; LG's Magic Remote works by radio once paired, so it doesn't mind either way (a check in the fit proof).
- **Heat:** every console bay is open front and back, the bricks lie flat at the back with nothing on top, and the Series X has 15 cm each side and 21 above.
- **One remote for most of it:** HDMI-CEC (SIMPLINK) lets the TV's remote work the soundbar and the modern consoles (step 13); the HDMI switch has its own remote for the retro side.

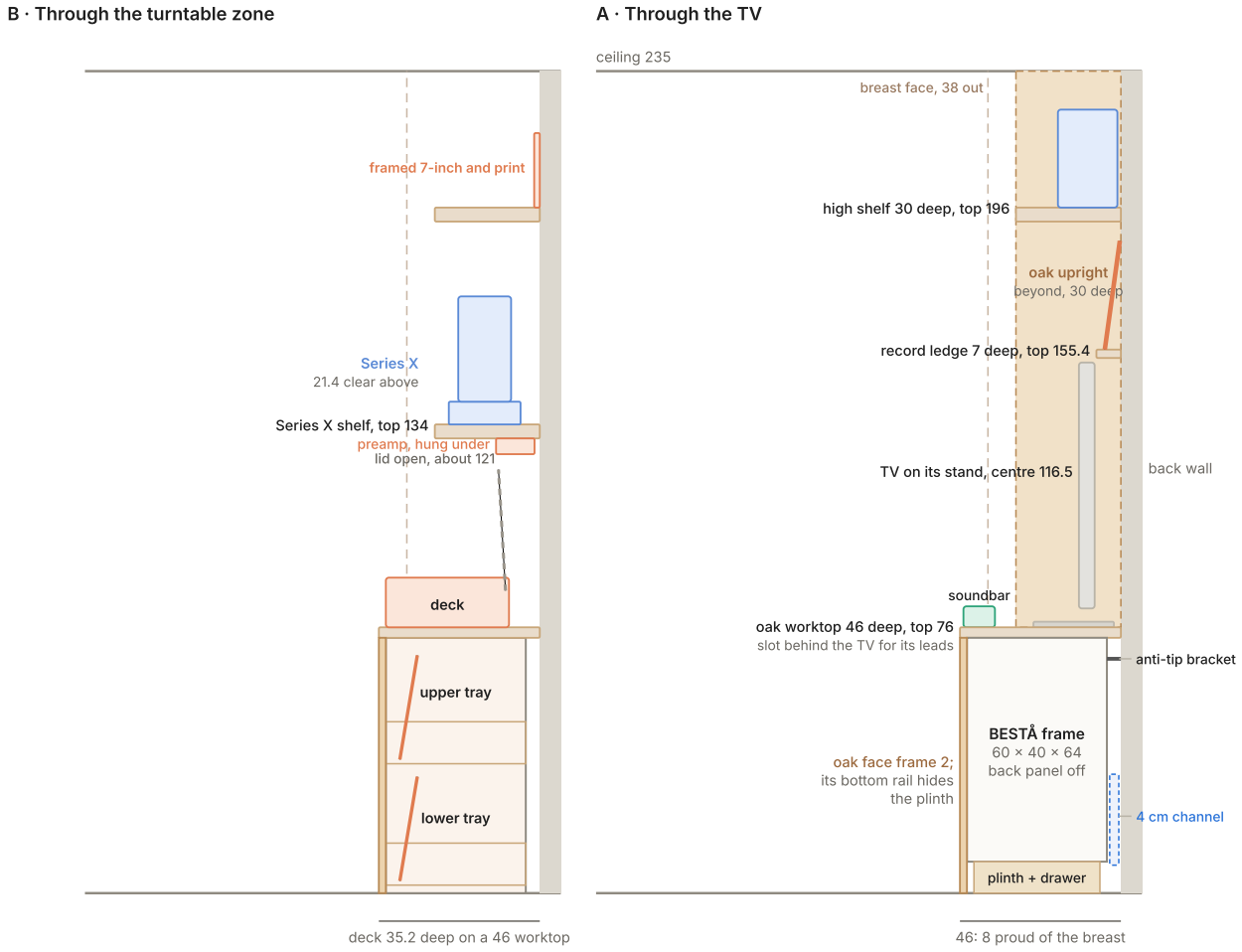
The media wall and the chimney breast from the front, to scale

The TV in line with the sofa, the turntable, Series X and records on the left, the consoles and games under the TV. Heights in cm



How the wall goes together, layer by layer

Side sections to scale, room on the left. Dashed: the upright and the breast's face beyond the cut, and the deck's lid open



The sub in the media wall

You asked for the sub back in the unit, with the Xbox bricks moved behind. It fits, and it sits in the best spot for it: under the TV, beside the soundbar, so the bass comes from the same place as the picture. Here's how the base makes room, and what was checked.

- **The bricks go to the back.** The Xbox One's brick (17 × 7.5 × 4.8[11]) and the Xbox 360's (allowed 21 × 10 × 6[16]) lie flat at the back of their shelves, by the channel's power leads. Microsoft asks for a ventilated space, flat on the rubber pads, with nothing on top[26]; the bays are open front and back.
- **That frees bay 1's fronts** beside the two Xboxes, so the HDMI switch (beside the Xbox One, where its remote reaches it) and the RetroTINK (beside the Xbox 360) move up from bay 2.
- **Bay 2's lower half becomes two columns:** the sub on the left, under the TV, and the PS2 over the PS1 on the right. The sub is 21.4 × 30.4 × 29.4[3]; its column is 23.4 wide and 35.3 tall.
- **The port:** the sub's front sits flush with the face frame, so its rear port is 15.6 cm from the wall through the open back and the channel. That's inside the 15–30 cm advised for a rear port[25], at the low end, so the channel behind bay 2 stays clear: Switch 2 and the retro 6-way move behind bay 1.
- **Vibration, the one thing to test:** Microsoft advises keeping the Xbox 360 away from subwoofers[27], and the deck shares the worktop. The 360 is a whole bay away, the sub stands on an isolation riser without touching the divider or the frame, and the deck has isolation feet. Once it's built, play a disc game and a record at film volume. If anything skips, turn the sub down for that source; if it still does, the sub can go back under the dining wall.

- **The dining wall is clear underneath:** no cover to make, and nothing to move for eight at the table.

The fit proof: every item against its published size

Each zone lists what goes in it, its size and its source (section 12), the space, what's left and a verdict. 92 of the 126 checks fit outright and none fail; 22 are tight, most of them snug by design; 12 need a check on site (the TV's plugs, the RetroTINK's size, the sub's vibration, the soundbar and the TV's remote eye, the stairs wall, and your shelf's height).

Where	Fit	Tight	Check	Tight or to check
The TV between the uprights	4	0	2	The TV's remote receiver, bottom centre of the screen's frame (check); The TV's HDMI plugs, with the screen 2.15 from the corner post (check)
The turntable zone, left of the TV	5	2	0	Turntable, AT-LP120X size (worst case) (tight); Phono preamp, hung under the shelf at the back (tight)
Shelves above the TV	4	0	0	—
Bay 1, Xbox (BESTÅ frame on the 9 cm plinth)	4	0	1	Xbox 360, original, + RetroTINK-6X CE (check)
Bay 2, PlayStation and the sub (BESTÅ frame on the plinth)	2	4	1	The sub in its column (tight); The sub's driver and port (tight); PS2, original, over the PS1 (tight); Vibration: the consoles and the deck share the base with the sub (check); Switch 2 (TL-SG108) and the retro 6-way in the channel (tight)
Bay 3: the LP crates and the slim game column	3	3	1	LPs in the crate (tight); Games in the slim drawers, face-out (tight); Pads in the top slim drawer (tight); The side-wall socket beside the slim drawers (check)
The side wall: one oak run from the corner to the PC	7	0	0	—
The compact dining cabinet (the plan)	18	3	2	The two doors and their hinges (check); The table standing up in its bay (tight); Two chairs in the base, on their sides (tight); Four chairs in the chair bay (tight); Stair side: the stair's foot and the door (check)
Your black shelf on the stairs wall (a fixed 10 cm gap)	3	0	1	Its stairs end (check)
Your picks (in the plan)	11	4	2	The record table: LPs (tight); The shelf over the door (check); Boxes on your black shelf (tight); D: its depth (tight); D: bottles (tight); The step drawers (check)
The C-table at the sofa's open end (in the plan)	5	0	0	—
How many can sit down	3	0	0	—
The chimney breast, with the table by the stairs	2	0	0	—
The glass display case on the chimney breast (in the plan)	4	1	0	Over the “now playing” sleeves (tight)

The room	6	0	0	—
Your plant stand and your vinyl stand	4	3	0	A: the plant stand in the window corner (recommended) (tight); A: LPs in its top bays, face-out (tight); B: the plant stand on the breast (tight)
The storage ottoman (replaces your blue cord one)	3	0	1	Its height (check)
Your rear speakers (from your photos)	4	1	0	In the gap behind the sofa (tight)

Safety

- **Wall cabinets, shoe cabinets, the bar and the media wall:** fix each to the wall with the anti-tip fittings for a solid wall; IKEA's own listings say they must be anchored.
- **Drilling:** check for pipes and cables with a detector before every hole; the side wall carries the PC's leads.
- **The step drawers:** a bearer under each tread once its riser is cut out: a joiner's job, or build them into the new stairs.
- **An old textured (Artex) ceiling:** if it's older than about 2000, have it tested for asbestos before sanding, drilling or skimming it.
- **Mains electrics:** the sockets and the light fittings: done to Part P, or by an electrician.
- **The dining table:** never swing it up or down with anything on it; check all four legs have clicked before you load it.
- **The record table:** about 65 kg with its LPs: roll it, don't lift it, and fit both lid stays so the lid can't drop.

4 · The records and the turntable

Your plant stand and your vinyl stand

- **Your plant stand:** 98 × 29.5 × 158. Two slatted towers of five tiers, with an open middle holding two shelves for taller plants.
- **Your vinyl stand:** 70 × 32 × 78. A black steel frame and rustic wood: two face-out bays on top, LPs standing between wire dividers below.
- **Sizes** from the listings you sent[32,33].
- **Two good places:** the window's west corner and the chimney breast (free now the table is by the stairs), so two layouts. In the 3D room, Tools › Layout switches between them; in Edit room you can drag either anywhere.
- **A, recommended: plants in the window corner, records on the breast.**
  - The plant stand goes against the window wall, between the curtains' stack and the pipe boxing: 107 cm for its 98, so 4.5 each side. Measure before it goes in; if it's tight, open the curtains' stack a little towards the window.
  - Its plants get daylight from the window beside them; at 158 it leaves 77 to the ceiling.
  - The vinyl stand goes on the breast, centred, under the “now playing” ledge (23.6 cm clear). Pick a record from its top bays, play it on the deck an arm's reach away, stand its sleeve on the ledge.
  - About 100 more LPs.
- **B: records in the window corner, as today, plants on the breast.**
  - The plants become the breast's display, 9.75 cm clear each side.
  - At 158 tall the stand comes up past the two frames, so the frames go up above it (or elsewhere) and the “now playing” ledge comes off.
- **Either way:**
  - Your red lamp moves from the window corner to the sofa's west end.
  - Drip trays or a waterproof mat under the pots protect the slats and the carpet.
  - Felt pads under the vinyl stand.



Layout A, from the 3D room: your plant stand in the window's west corner.



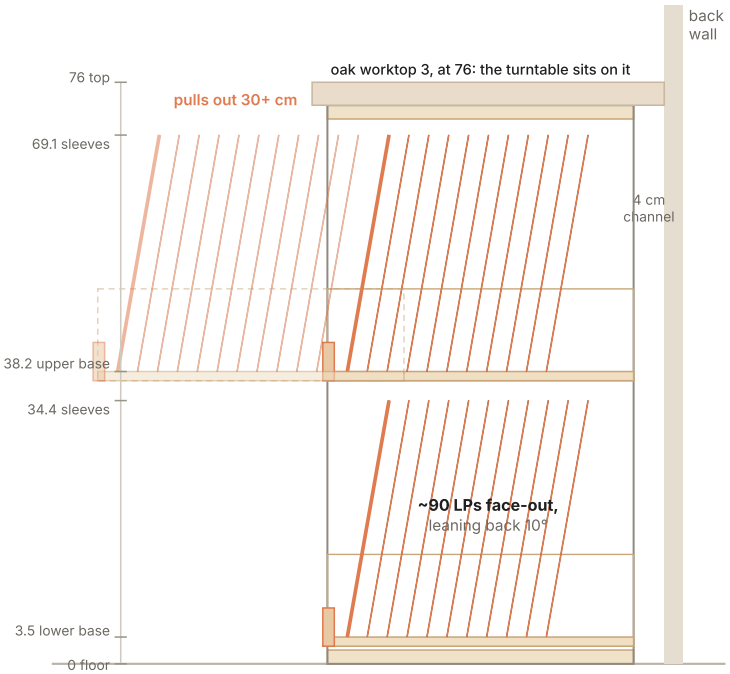
Layout A: your vinyl stand on the chimney breast, under the “now playing” ledge, beside the turntable.

The vinyl is in one place, in the alcove: the deck on the worktop, the records in the two LP crates right underneath it, the preamp tucked under the shelf above, and the “now playing” ledge on the breast an arm's reach away. Pull a crate, pick a record, play it, and stand its sleeve on the ledge.

Bay 3: two LP crates under the turntable, a slim game column beside them

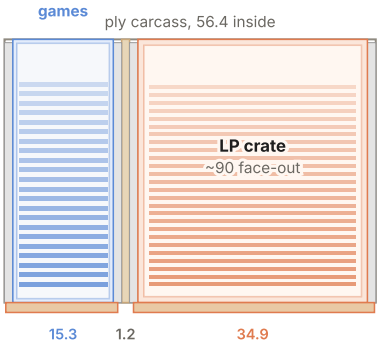
Section left through the LP crates, plan right. Pull a crate and flip through the covers like a record shop browser; the slim drawers flip the same way for games

Side section through bay 3



carcass 18 mm birch ply, 60 × 40 × 73, back open to the channel · crates 40 deep on 400 mm runners
12 mm base, 9 mm sides, 5 cm oak lip · 2.6 and 2.1 cm finger room (top panel at 71.2)

Bay 3 from above



LP crate 34.9 × 40, a 33.1 trough: LPs snug, no dead space
slim drawers 15.3 × 40, 14.1 inside: DVD-size cases face-out
12 mm ply divider · 12.7 mm runners each side
an LP crate is about 30 kg full: open one at a time

The glass display case on the chimney breast

You picked it: a tall glass case on the breast, 90 × 85 × 12 deep, centred from 137 to 222, 13 under the ceiling. Three 6 mm glass shelves on pins, a 4 mm toughened front that lifts off[64], a warm strip inside. An oak frame from the offcuts on a hidden cleat, about 16 kg empty. Step 9 builds it; about £90–170.



The case on the breast with collectibles, the “now playing” ledge and your vinyl stand under it.



The same case with a black frame and a bit of everything: 7-inch singles, a cap and figures, small plants.

The turntable zone

- **The deck:** on isolation feet, 2 cm back from the worktop's front edge, with 8.8 cm behind it for the lid's hinges. The zone takes a deck up to the size of an AT-LP120X (45.2 × 35.2 cm); most decks are smaller.
- **The lid:** AT's cover is 44.1 × 34.6 cm[17], so standing open its top edge is at about 121; the shelf's underside is at 130.
- **Bass:** the sub is in bay 2, in the same base the deck sits on. It stands on an isolation riser, clear of the divider and the frame, and the deck stands on isolation feet. If a record skips or hums at film volume, turn the sub down for vinyl.
- **Signal path:** turntable set to PHONO → the preamp under the shelf → a 2 m RCA-to-3.5 mm lead down the groove behind the left upright and along the back of the worktop to the soundbar's AUX. If the deck has no PHONO/LINE switch, plug it straight into the AUX.
- **Soundbar:** Music mode, bass up, surround, night and dialogue modes off. Always the AUX cable, never Bluetooth.

Where every record lives

Where	What	How many
Bay 3, the two LP crates	LPs, face-out	About 180 LPs
The breast	The “now playing” ledge	3 LPs, the one that's on and the next two
Above the TV	Oak record ledge, the "now playing" wall	4 LPs
Side wall	The oak run round the corner	4 LPs
Your vinyl stand	LPs, face-out on top, spine-up below	About 100 LPs (50 + 50)
Total		**About 291 LPs: 191 in the wall, every one face-out, and 100 in the stand**

If the collection is bigger than this, tell me the count. The neatest overflow is another LP column like bay 3's (40 wide, two crates, 180 LPs), or LPs spine-out on the high shelf.

5 · The dining wall

The compact dining cabinet is the plan: you asked for "a smaller build on the cabinet", so the same table and the same six chairs now pack into **two oak boxes side by side**, 147.2 × 23.4 × 189, under your shelf by the stairs, 1.4 cm proud of the pipe boxing. Shut, it's two plain oak doors. Open, the table is 185 × 90 and six sit in comfort, three a side, on your grey padded chairs.



Packed away, in the 3D room: the table box and the chair box side by side.

- **Where the length went.** Two chairs now **lie on their sides in the table box's base**, under the hinge rail, where the sliding cabinet had its drawer. The other four **stand in a box one chair wide**: two deep on its floor and two deep on its shelf. The chairs are padded, so there are no seat pads to keep.
- **Hinged doors that turn right back.** Each door hangs on a full-height stainless piano hinge[49] with its knuckle just in front of the faces, so it turns 180° and lies flat over its neighbour. Nothing stands out into the room. Open, the table door reaches 36.1 past the cabinet's window end, 9.2 clear of your plant stand.
- **The table box, at the stair end** (91 inside). The 185 × 90 solid oak table stands up in it in two 92.5 × 90 halves, folded face to face, on its oak hinge rail at 73.3. The two lying chairs are underneath it. Above it is the **linen shelf** for the cloth, the napkins, the runner and the candles.
- **The chair box, at the window end** (49 inside): four folded chairs, 2 cm wider than a chair, with a fixed shelf at 95.8.
- **The table is unchanged:** the two halves meet flush on three brass flip-top hinges[30], each a centre of staves between pegged breadboard ends. Four tapered oak legs fold flat inside the aprons. Each half is about 16 kg.

Using it

1. **Opening:** clear the floor in front of it and push the ottoman to the sofa. Open the chair door, lay it back over the table door and take the four chairs out, then shut it.
2. Open the table door and lay it back over the chair door, where a flush magnet holds it. Lift the two chairs out of the base, front one first.

3. Pull the finger pull at the top of the folded table and lower it halfway on its piano hinge[43]. Unfold the inner half's two legs until each clicks[44], then lower it onto them. Lift the outer half up and over, unfold its legs until they click, and lower it. The table is 185 long, its top at 76, level with the media wall's worktop.
4. **Folding away:** do it the other way round. Fold the legs and the outer half, swing the table up until the catches take it, then put the two chairs in the base and shut the table door. Then the four chairs go in the chair box. Use two hands, and never fold it with anything on the table.

The chairs: your grey padded ones

Your chairs[62]: Brayden Studio's **wooden folding chairs in linen**, sold in pairs, a 47 × 47 seat with a 6.5 cm cushion, 168 kg each. **Folded they're 90 × 10 × 47**: only 1 cm thicker and 1 cm taller than the beech FRÖSVI the cabinet was drawn for, so they pack in the same way with three small changes:

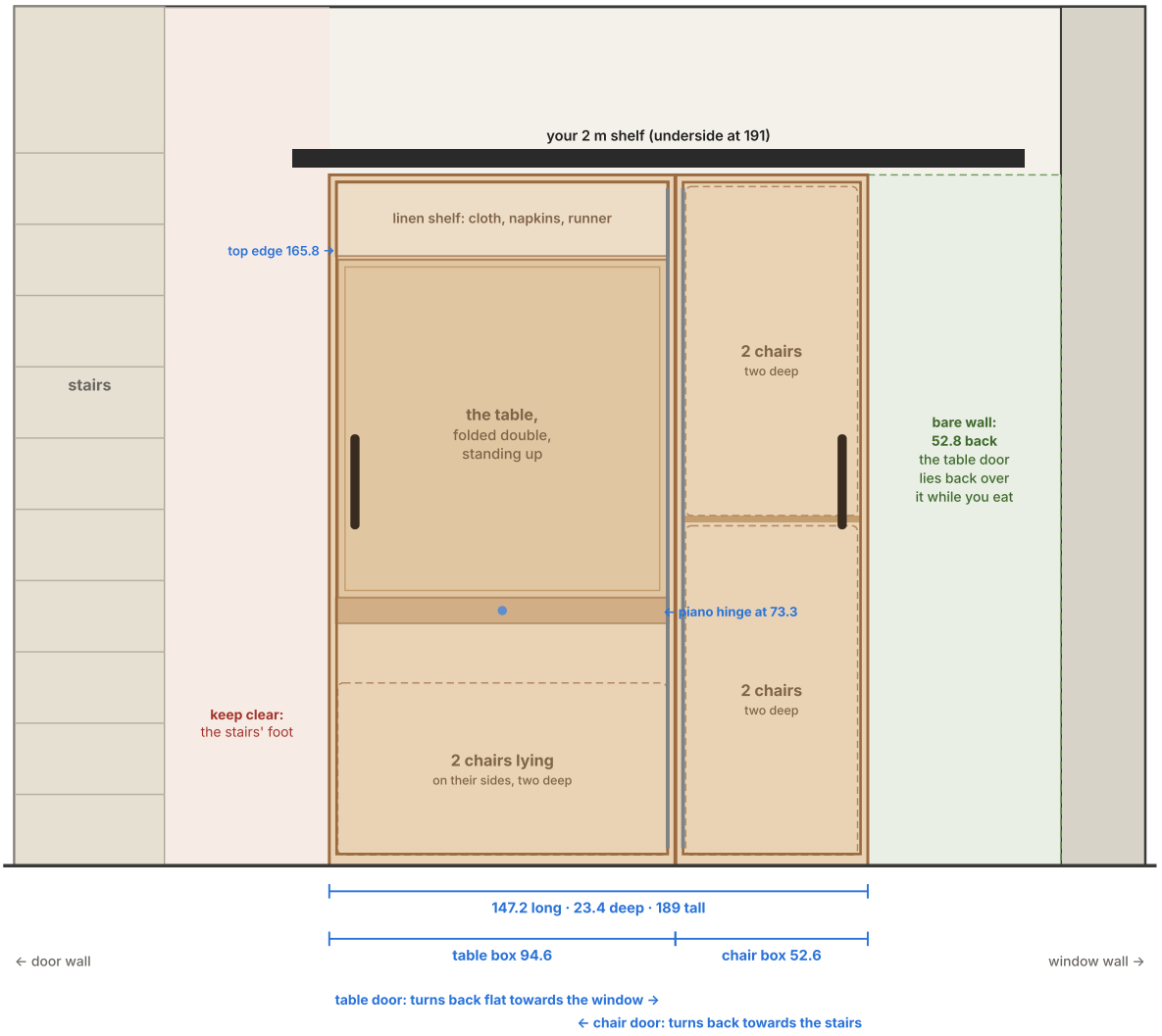
- **23.4 deep instead of 22**, so two stand one behind the other (20.8 inside for two at 10). The cabinet stands 1.4 cm proud of the pipe boxing.
- **The chair box 49 wide inside** (was 46), for a 47 chair: the cabinet is 147.2 long.
- **The chair shelf at 94** (was 93.5), so a 90 chair stands under it and over it with a centimetre to spare. Two still lie in the table box's base, 0.5 clear at each end.

The listing doesn't give the open chair's depth, height or seat height, so those are drawn at a like-for-like chair's[63]: 61 deep, 78.7 tall, the seat at 44.5. Seated on the stair side, a chair's back reaches into the door's swing: **keep the door shut while you eat** unless they measure 52.3 deep or less. About £80–130 a pair.

The idea is a proven one: fold-down tables built into wall units are made this way[45]. Your stairs wall is solid (your answer)[50], so the boxes stand on the floor and are screwed to the wall at the top with plugs and screws so they can't tip.

The compact dining cabinet, packed away

The stairs wall from the room, to scale (1 cm = 2.55 px). Doors see-through: the table and two chairs behind the table door, four chairs behind the chair door.





The chair door turned back flat over the table door: four folded chairs.

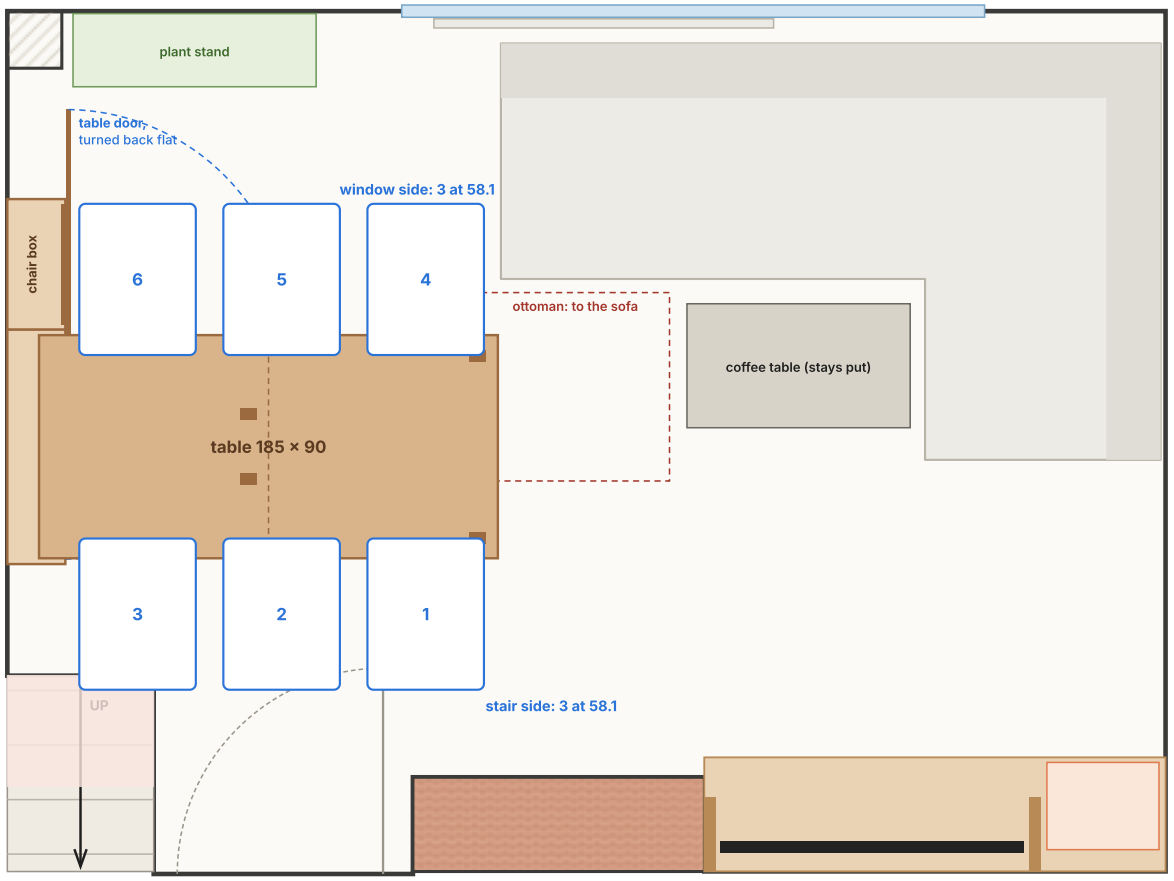
How many sit down

Six, all in comfort: three on the stair side (58.1 cm of edge each) and three on the window side (58.1 each, from the sofa's arm to the cabinet). The open table door clears the nearest window-side chair by 3.3 cm. The coffee table stays where it is, and a seventh chair fits at the far end if you bring one.

Table	Seats	How	Notes
The compact cabinet (the plan)	6 in comfort	3 on the stair side, 3 on the window side	58.1 and 58.1 of edge each; a seventh at the far end with a spare chair
The 80-wide version	6 in comfort	3 on the stair side, 3 on the window side	58.1 and 58.1 of edge each; a seventh at the far end with a spare chair; four chairs inside, not six
A fourth chair a side	eight round it	174.4 and 174.4 of edge	43.6 each: under the 55 squeeze
A longer table in the cabinet	halves over 113.9	they must stand up under your shelf	113.9 is the most that folds away; 92.5 leaves the linen shelf's space

The compact cabinet open for six

From above, to scale. The table door turned back flat over the chair door and the wall beyond (dashed: its swing); three a side, all in comfort.





Open for six in the 3D room: the table door turned back flat over the chair door.

The bar beside the cabinet

A back-bar 42.5 wide between the cabinet and the pipe boxing, 22.4 deep: no deeper than the open table door. A cupboard for 16 bottles[66], an oak counter at 90[92], a 3 mm acrylic mirror[65] and an IKEA ENHET frame[90] over it, 4 under your black shelf. With the table door back, 35.8 of it is behind the door: set the drinks out first.



The bar beside the dining cabinet, under your black shelf.



Open: the bottles inside, glasses on the frame.

- **Build:** 18 mm oak-faced ply as for the cabinet: two ends scribed to the cabinet and the wall, a floor on a 3 cm plinth set back 2, a shelf at 40.8, a 6 mm back, two doors on soft-close hinges; the 27 mm oak

counter screwed up through the ends; the carcass screwed to the wall, the plinth to the floor. Then the mirror, stuck on, and the ENHET frame on its own fixings, anchored as IKEA says.

6 · The side wall

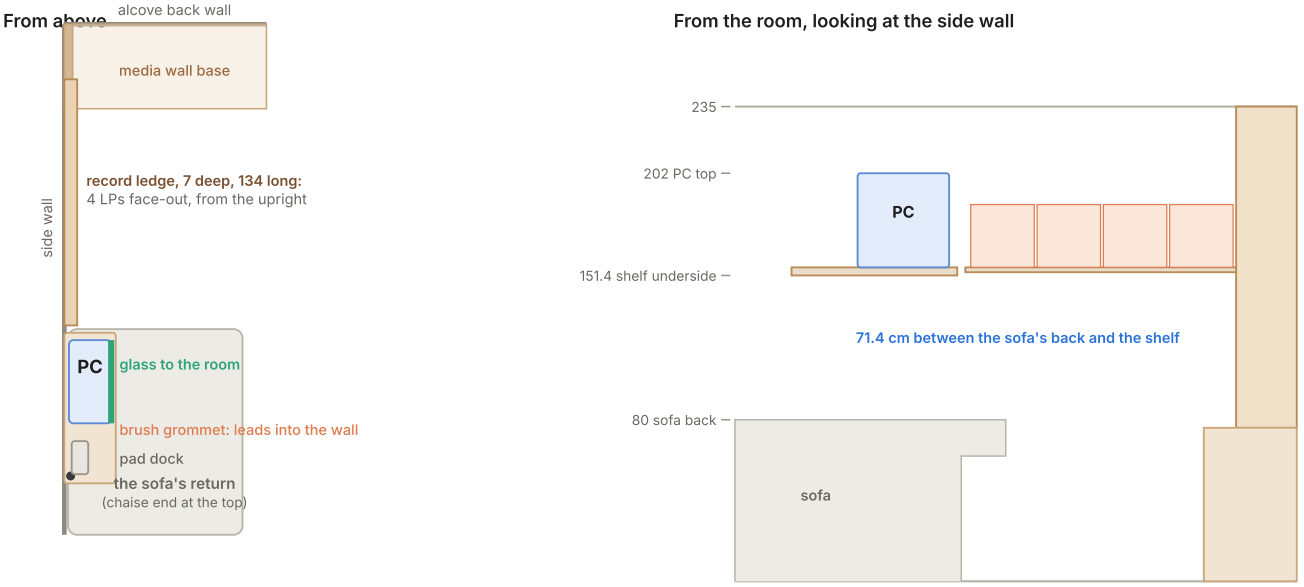
One oak line at 155.4 cm runs over the TV between the uprights and, past the turntable zone, along the side wall. On the side wall it's **one run**, 4 thick: a 7 cm ledge with four LPs face-out that sweeps out to the 28 cm PC shelf. A warm LED strip under its front edge washes the wall below.



The side wall from the room: the oak run round the corner with its four LPs.

The side wall: the ledge wraps the corner, the PC sits above the sofa

One oak line at 155.4 cm: the record ledge from the upright, then the PC shelf over the end of the sofa, clear of the TV's sightlines



- **The run:** 220 cm long, 4 thick, cut from one 225 × 30 × 4 oak board to a full-size template: 7 deep along the LPs (with a 1.5 cm lip), easing out to 28 over 14 cm just past the last LP. It sits on an oak cleat

screwed to the side wall, dowelled to the left upright's front edge.

- **The PC end:** 82 × 28 cm, on two concealed heavy-duty brackets (40 kg+ a pair) as well as the cleat, 71.4 cm above the sofa's back. The case sits with its glass to the room and its front towards the alcove. The ports face the window and stay open to the air (no screen, so nothing traps the exhaust); from the sofa you look at the glass side, not the ports. The pad dock sits beyond the case.
- **Cables:** through a brush grommet at the shelf's back corner straight into a 25 mm conduit chased into the side wall (it's solid, as you confirmed), down to skirting height and behind the skirting to the base's plinth; you chase it yourselves in step 3, with a second, smaller conduit beside it for the PC's mains lead, then it's filled and painted, so nothing shows. A draw wire left in it pulls the next lead through. The HDMI is an active optical cable (about 5 m), "source" end at the PC.
- **Power:** the PC plugs into the 10-gang behind the TV: its lead (a 5 m C13 lead with a rewireable plug, fed down bare and the plug fitted at the bottom) runs in its own 25 mm conduit beside the data one. The 10-gang's load check, with the PC, is in section 9. No new socket.
- **Keyboard tray (back from v6.1):** the shelf sits on a 7 cm oak housing with a tray on 300 mm light-duty runners that rolls 25 cm out towards the room. It holds a full-size wireless keyboard and mouse: pull it out, lift the keyboard onto your lap, park it again. The housing stops 12 cm short of the sofa end so the cables drop past it; its underside is 144.4, 64.4 above the sofa's back.
- **Headroom:** the shelf's underside is at 151.4, and it covers only the 28 cm of the sofa nearest the wall.

The PC end, looked over again

- **Air:** a mid-tower draws in at the front (towards the alcove) and blows out at the back and top. Both stay open: the case's top is at 202, 33 clear of the ceiling; a magnetic dust filter on the top exhaust keeps the dust out while it's off.
- **Reach from the sofa:** the PC's own power button is on its top, behind your head. A remote power button (a small card on the motherboard's power pins and a push button under the wrap ledge by the sofa end) starts it from the seat, and a powered USB 3 hub under the run's front edge puts pads, the keyboard's dongle and a stick within reach.
- **Lit, and seen:** the glass side faces the room, so its fans and lights read as part of the wall at night (the 3D view's "PC lit" button shows it). Keep its lights on a slow single colour if they pull the eye from the TV.
- **Leads:** labelled at both ends (step 13), all three down the chased conduits; nothing hangs below the shelf.

7 · The oak joinery

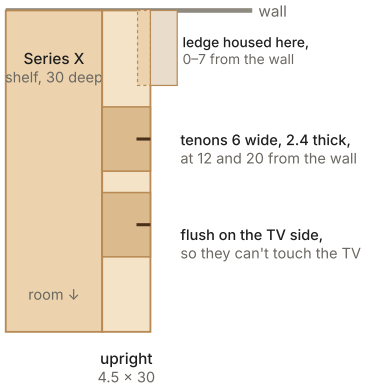
Above the worktop the wall is furniture rather than cladding: two solid oak uprights, shelves carried on joints you can see, and the Card Room Green wall showing between them.

- **Uprights:** solid oak, 4.5 × 30 cm, 159 cm long, each on two 10 mm dowels into the worktop, scribed to the ceiling and held to the back wall with concealed brackets; the left one also screws to the side wall.
- **Wedged through-tenons:** the Series X shelf (top 134) passes through the left upright on two tenons, 6 cm wide and 2.4 thick, 12 and 20 cm from the wall. They're wedged and planed flush: standing proud, they'd touch the TV.
- **Housed and pegged:** the high shelf (two lengths, top 196) and the record ledge (top 155.4) are housed 1.2 cm into the uprights and pinned with 10 mm oak pegs, which show as dark dots.
- **LED grooves:** a routed groove on each upright's inner face holds a smart colour strip that washes the wall either side of the TV: warm white day to day, any colour for a scene.
- **Hidden cables:** a 2 × 1.5 cm groove down the back of the left upright carries the Series X's HDMI and power and the vinyl lead; the same groove in the right upright carries Deco B's 12 V lead and patch lead.
- **Finish:** hardwax oil throughout; lightly limed or smoked oak avoids the bright orange "new oak" look.

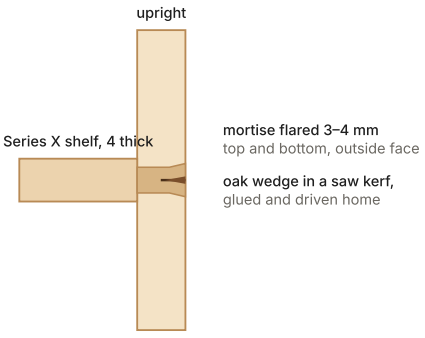
Artisan oak: how the joints work

Drawn to scale at 7 px per cm. The joints carry the load and are left on show, finished in hardwax oil

A · Wedged through-tenons, from above

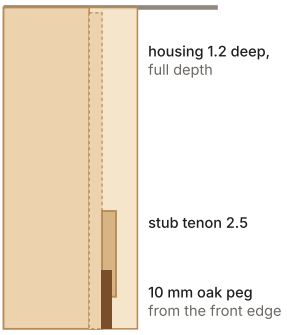


B · The same joint from the front



The kerf runs flat, so the wedge spreads the tenon up and down, along the upright's grain, and can't split it.

C · Housed shelf, pegged



high shelf / ledge
seen from above

• Through-tenons (A, B): the Series X shelf (top 134) passes through the left upright on two tenons, 12 and 20 cm from the wall, wedged and planed flush: proud, they'd touch the TV.

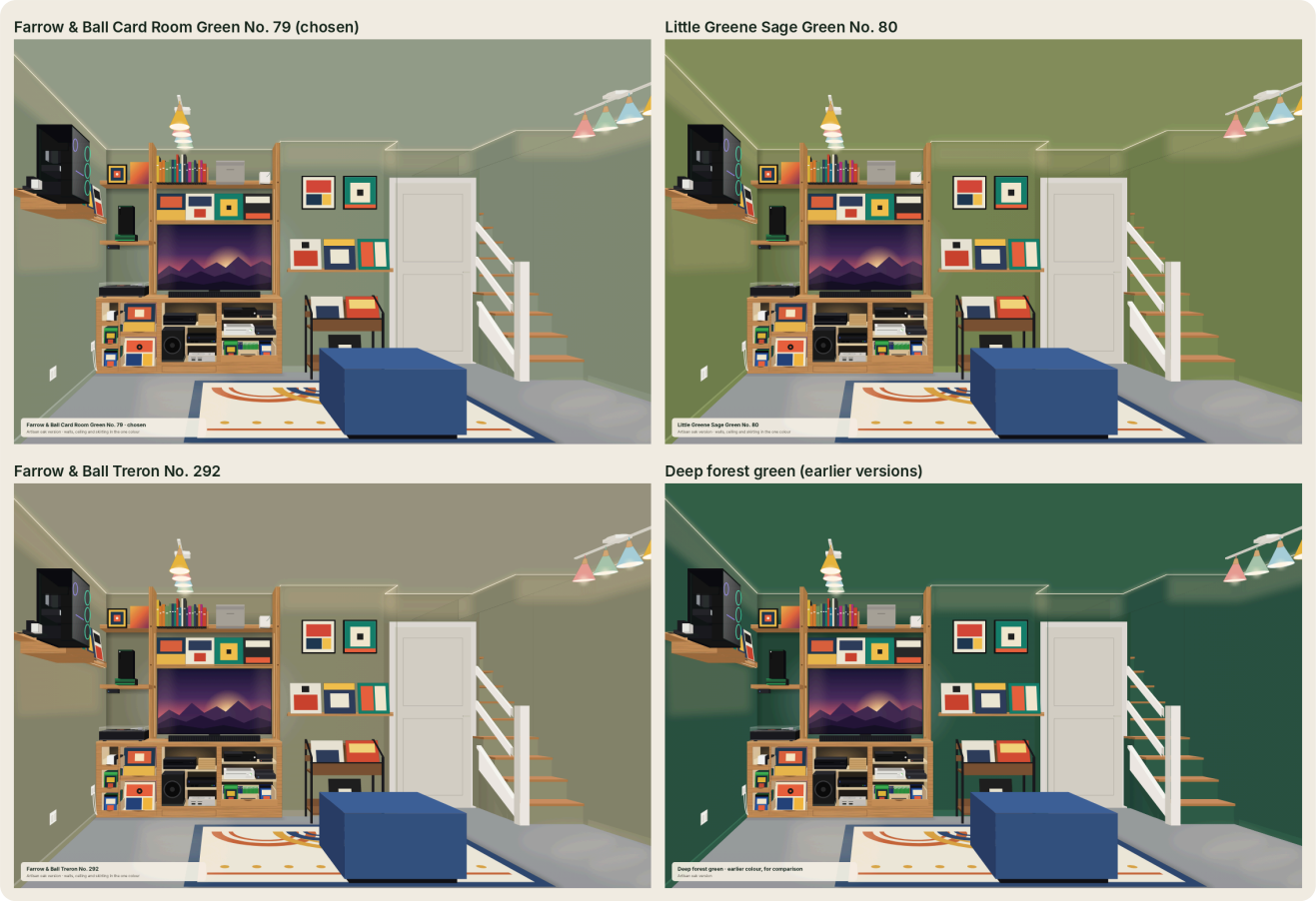
• Housed and pegged (C): the three lengths of the high shelf (top 196) and the record ledge (top 155.4). The peg shows as a dark dot on the upright's face.

• Uprights: 159 long, worktop to ceiling, each on two 10 mm dowels into the worktop, scribed to the ceiling, with two concealed brackets. The left one also screws to the side wall, and

8 · Paint and light

Paint: Farrow & Ball Card Room Green No. 79

The room is colour-drenched in Card Room Green: walls, ceiling, alcove, chimney breast, skirting and the radiator. The door and its frame stay white, as they are: a crisp edge to the green, like the window. There's no trunking left to paint. It's a soft grey-green that lets the oak and the records lead.



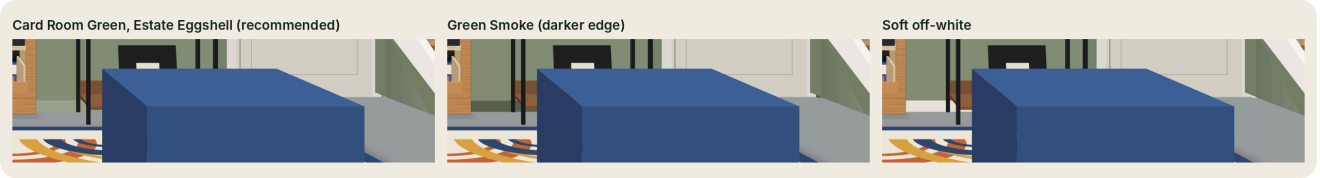
The wall in Card Room Green (chosen) beside Sage Green, Treron and the earlier deep green.

- **Finishes:** Estate or Modern Emulsion on walls, ceiling, alcove and breast; Estate Eggshell in the same colour on skirting and radiator (the door stays white) (Modern Eggshell if the skirting takes knocks).
- **Order:** paint before anything is fixed, so nothing needs cutting in round the uprights, shelves or the dining wall.

Wall	Area (less window and door)	Two coats
Media wall	6.2 m²	0.9 L
Chimney breast	3.7 m²	0.5 L
Door wall	0.8 m²	0.1 L
Stairs wall	6.3 m²	0.9 L
Window wall	10.2 m²	1.5 L
PC wall	7.3 m²	1.0 L
All walls	**34.4 m²**	**4.9 L: two 2.5 L tins**[89]

Trying a different colour on one wall in the 3D room (Look): that wall needs one 2.5 L tin.

Skirting: Card Room Green too



Recommended: Card Room Green in Estate Eggshell, which completes the drench and hides scuffs far better than white. Darker option: Green Smoke. Over the white gloss: wash, key, woodwork primer, two coats of eggshell.

Light, in three warm layers

- **The LED strip on the ceiling** (as now): round the room's edge, into the alcove and across the breast; 2700K on a dimmer.
- **Built into the oak (smart colour):** an RGB and tunable-white strip in each upright's groove and one under the side-wall run's front edge[37], in the same app as the bars' bulbs, so each scene sets them too; on their plug-in power on the 10-gang (no fused spur). The 6500K bias light on the back of the TV stays plain white: it's there for the picture, not the mood.
- **Your red lamp:** the three-headed floor lamp you have, its colour bulbs green at the top, pink in the middle and purple at the bottom. A deep green room needs a low layer as well as the light from above; it's also the one to leave on for a film. It can stand in any of the three spots in the 3D room.
- **Two spot bars** in the style of Dunelm's Wolston (£49 each; 84 × 16 cm, 22.4 cm drop; 4 × E14, 6 W max[14]) on your two existing ceiling points, **both running from the TV towards the window**. Bar 1 hangs on the rose straight out from the TV unit, halfway to the sofa; bar 2 on the pendant point by the stairs, along the west wall, so its end no longer comes near that wall. **Smart colour bulbs**: eight E14 bulbs under the bar's 6 W, the WiZ Colour P45 (4.9 W, 4.5 × 10.1 cm) or, if it shows below a shade, the shorter Philips Hue lustre (5.1 W, 4.5 × 7.7 cm)[38]. Smart bulbs need full power, so **no dimmers**: the wall switches stay as they are and stay on; level and colour come from the app (or an optional smart button). **Turn them as you like:** each bar turns on its rose and clears every wall at any angle (bar 2 by 5.5 cm), and each head aims on its own; tap a bar or the red lamp in the 3D room to try it.

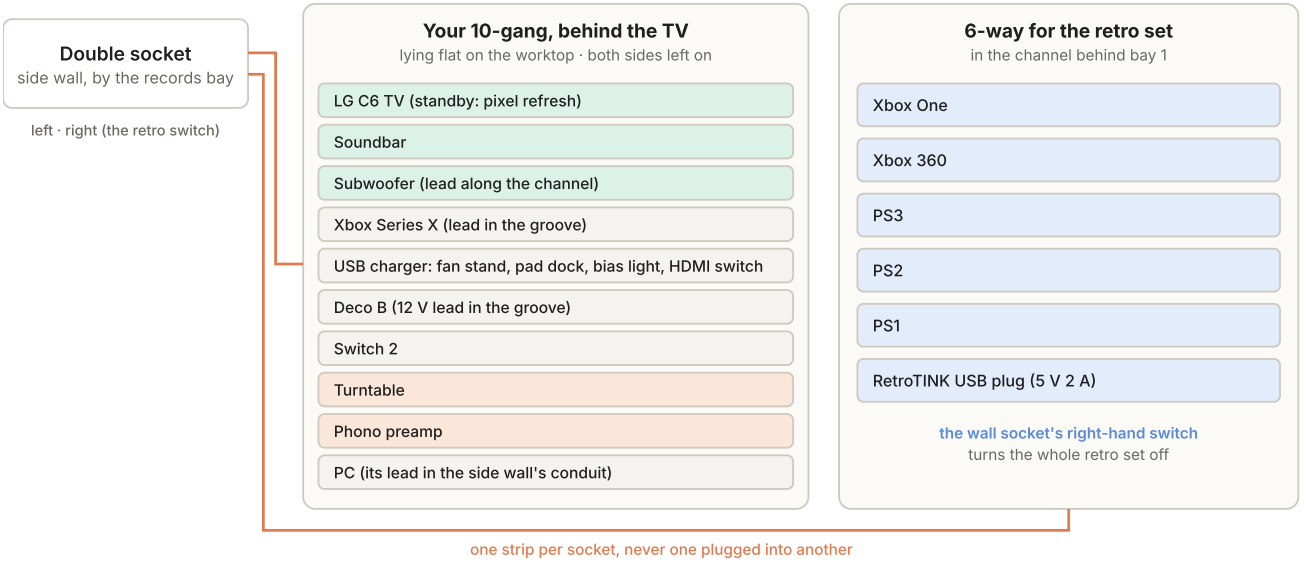
Where the heads point: all eight heads straight down, evenly spread along each bar, so their pools overlap into one even light over the room: that's the **Bright** preset, the default. Tilt a head only if its pool lands badly (in the TV's screen from the sofa, or in someone's eyes). Set the bulbs to warm white (3000K) for Bright, 2700K for Cosy, and save colours for the presets you want them in.

9 · Power, cables and network

Power

Power map: your 10-gang (now with the PC) plus a 6-way for the retro set

Everything modern on the left outlet, always on; the five retro consoles and the RetroTINK on the right, switched at the wall



- The socket on the side wall is a single today: you swap it for a double at the same spot (like for like, your own job: step 3).
- The retro switch moves to the wall: with the TV 2 cm from the left upright, the 10-gang's own switches can't be reached any more.
- Rear speakers: your double socket behind the sofa's short side. Your lamp and the grow lights: the double behind the plant stand.
- The sub plugs into the 10-gang: its lead drops through the worktop's slot to the back of bay 2. Both spot bars use existing ceiling points.
- Load check: the 10-gang about 1.55 kW with everything on, PC included (850 W at most); the 6-way up to 0.8 kW. Each under 13 A (3 kW).
- Check the 10-gang is surge-protected; if not, use a surge-protected one for the TV and consoles. Label both outlets.

- **The socket:** the single on the side wall just in front of the records bay, about 30 cm up, becomes a double at the same spot. The left outlet feeds the 10-gang; the right one feeds the retro 6-way, so its own switch is now the retro switch. The 10-gang's switches sit behind the TV, where you can't reach them any more.
- **10-gang:** lying flat on the worktop behind the TV, both sides left on: TV, soundbar, sub, Series X, USB charger, Deco B, Switch 2, the deck, the preamp and now the PC. With everything running that's about 1.55 kW (the PC's 850 W at most), under the strip's 13 A (3 kW).
- **Retro 6-way:** in the channel behind bay 1 (bay 2's back is the sub's port): Xbox One, Xbox 360, PS3, PS2, PS1, RetroTINK.
- **OLED care:** leave the TV in standby so it runs its pixel refresh.

Socket by socket

Socket	Feeds	On or off
Side wall, double, left outlet	The 10-gang behind the TV: TV, soundbar, sub, Series X, USB charger (fan stand, pad dock, bias light, HDMI switch), Deco B, Switch 2, the turntable, the preamp, the PC and the uprights' LED driver	Always on: about 1.55 kW with everything running, PC included

Side wall, double, right outlet	The retro 6-way in the channel: Xbox One, Xbox 360, PS3, PS2, PS1, the RetroTINK's USB plug	The wall switch is the retro switch: off between sessions; up to about 0.8 kW with a launch PS3
Behind the sofa's short side, double (yours)	The rear speakers; a spare outlet for a phone charger or a lamp by the sofa	On
Window wall behind the plant stand, double (yours)	Your red lamp and the plant stand's grow lights: both within reach of it, layout A	On; the grow lights on a plug-in timer
Ceiling points 1 and 2	The two spot bars, with smart colour bulbs	Switches left on; level and colour from the app

One strip per outlet, never one plugged into another, and each under its 13 A (3 kW) limit: about 1.55 kW on the 10-gang and up to 0.8 kW on the retro 6-way, about 10 A together.

Electrics: your own job

You're doing the electrics yourselves. In England, Part P of the Building Regulations decides what needs an electrician or building control.

- **Notifiable (not for you):** a new circuit, a replacement consumer unit, or any change to a circuit round a bath or shower.
- **Not notifiable (yours):** the socket swapped for a double, and the two spot bars in place of the old fittings. Like for like, so no electrician and no building control.
- **Still to the wiring regulations** (BS 7671), every time.
- **The light switches stay:** the bars' smart bulbs need full power, so there are no dimmers to fit.
- **Not mains work at all:** the Cat6 and the conduits.

The safe routine, every time

1. **Isolate:** switch off that circuit's breaker at the consumer unit (the lighting circuit for the bars, the socket circuit for the socket). If the labels aren't clear, switch off the main switch.
2. **Lock off:** fit the MCB lock-off and padlock, keep the key in your pocket, and tape a note on the board.
3. **Prove dead:** check the tester lights on its proving unit, test between every pair of terminals (live–neutral, live–earth, neutral–earth), then check the tester on the proving unit again.
4. **Photograph** the wiring before you disconnect anything, and connect the new one wire for wire: brown (or red) to L, blue (or black) to N, green-and-yellow to earth, sleeved, no copper showing, every screw tight.
5. **Test:** power back on, then the socket tester in both outlets; each bar's four bulbs come on and join the app.

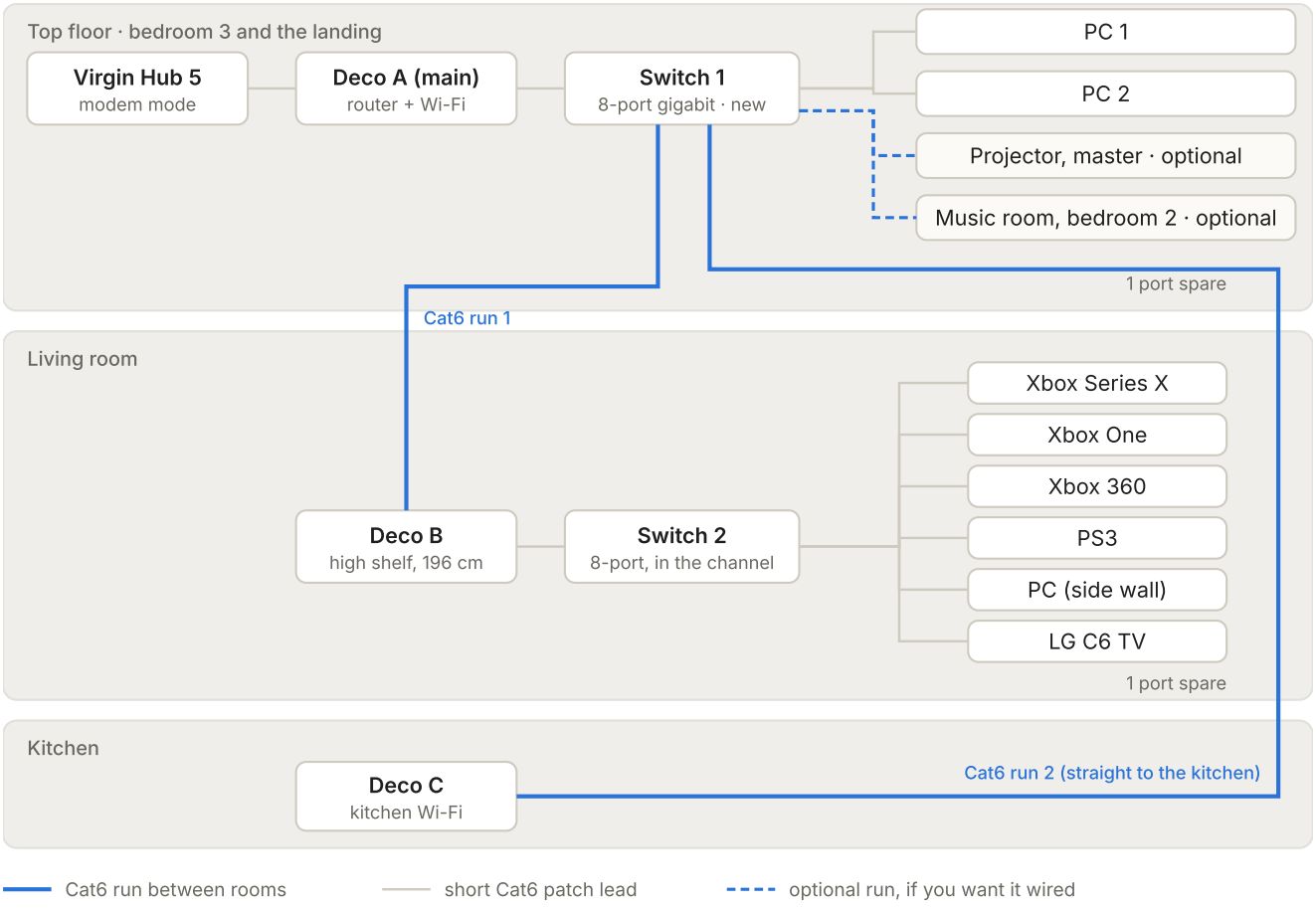
Stop and call an electrician if...

- the tester shows anything live after you've isolated;
- the wiring is old (rubber or fabric sheath, or red and black with no earth), or there's no earth at a ceiling point (the spot bars need one);
- there are more wires than you can match to your photo (two-way switching, a loop in a ceiling rose you can't follow), or scorch marks, or a loose, hot or crumbling fitting;
- the consumer unit has rewireable fuses or no RCD;
- a job grows into a new circuit, consumer unit work, or anything by the bath or shower.

Network

Every floor has its own Cat6 link back to bedroom 3

Deco A and Switch 1 live with the Hub 5 and the gaming PCs in bedroom 3; two spare ports can wire the projector and the music room



- **Bedroom 3:** the Hub 5 (in modem mode), Deco A and Switch 1 sit together with the gaming PCs. Switch 1's eight ports: the uplink, two PCs, the two Cat6 runs down to Deco B and Deco C, and, if you want them, the projector in the master and the music room in bedroom 2.
- **The route down:** across the landing to the airing cupboard, which sits over the alcove's corner, and down through its floor. Run 1 comes through the living room ceiling in the alcove's right corner to Deco B; run 2 follows the right upright's groove down and through the floor to the kitchen, where Deco C goes on the outside of the brick cupboard, up high.
- **Sloped ceilings:** bedroom 2 and the bathroom slope down to the back wall; keep any Deco or desk in bedroom 2 on the high side.

What each part does

Part	Where	Job	Why it's needed
Virgin Hub 5, in modem mode	Bedroom 3	Brings the internet in, nothing else	Two routers fighting (double NAT) breaks Xbox online play; its Wi-Fi switches off
Deco A (main)	Bedroom 3	The router: Wi-Fi, parental controls, HomeShield	HomeShield and parental controls only work when the Deco is the router
Switch 1, 8-port	Bedroom 3	Turns Deco A's spare port into seven	The two PCs, both Cat6 runs down, and the optional projector and music-room runs
Deco B	Living room, high shelf at 196	Wi-Fi for the living room, and the wired point for the wall	Fixes the living room's weak 5 GHz side
Switch 2, 8-port	Standing on edge in the channel behind the base	Turns Deco B's spare port into seven	The Series X, Xbox One, Xbox 360, PS3, PC and TV each get a cable, one port spare
Deco C	Kitchen, high on the outside of the brick cupboard	Wi-Fi for the kitchen	The kitchen gets poor signal on every band today
Cat6 runs 1 and 2	Bedroom 3 → airing cupboard → alcove corner, and on to the kitchen	The wired link between Decos ("Ethernet backhaul")	Without it the Decos relay each other over the 5 GHz band the phones use, losing speed at each hop

Stage 1: the mesh up today, before any cables

1. Unplug everything from the hub. Log in at 192.168.0.1 with the password on its base, then Modem Mode → Enable Modem Mode → Apply. Its settings page moves to 192.168.100.1.
2. Connect a hub port to Deco A and set it up in the Deco app, reusing the old Wi-Fi name and password. If it shows no internet, try another port and restart the hub.
3. Plug Switch 1 into Deco A's other port, then the PCs into Switch 1.
4. Add Deco B in the living room and Deco C in the kitchen. For now they link over Wi-Fi.
5. Check the Xbox's network settings show NAT: Open.

Stage 2: after your Cat6 runs (step 3)

1. Plug run 1 into Deco B's free port (Switch 2 stays in the other) and run 2 into Deco C.
2. In the Deco app, check Deco B and Deco C show as "Ethernet".
3. Plug the Series X, Xbox One, Xbox 360, PS3, PC and TV into Switch 2.
4. Under QoS, give the Series X and the PC high priority; turn on guest Wi-Fi and automatic firmware.

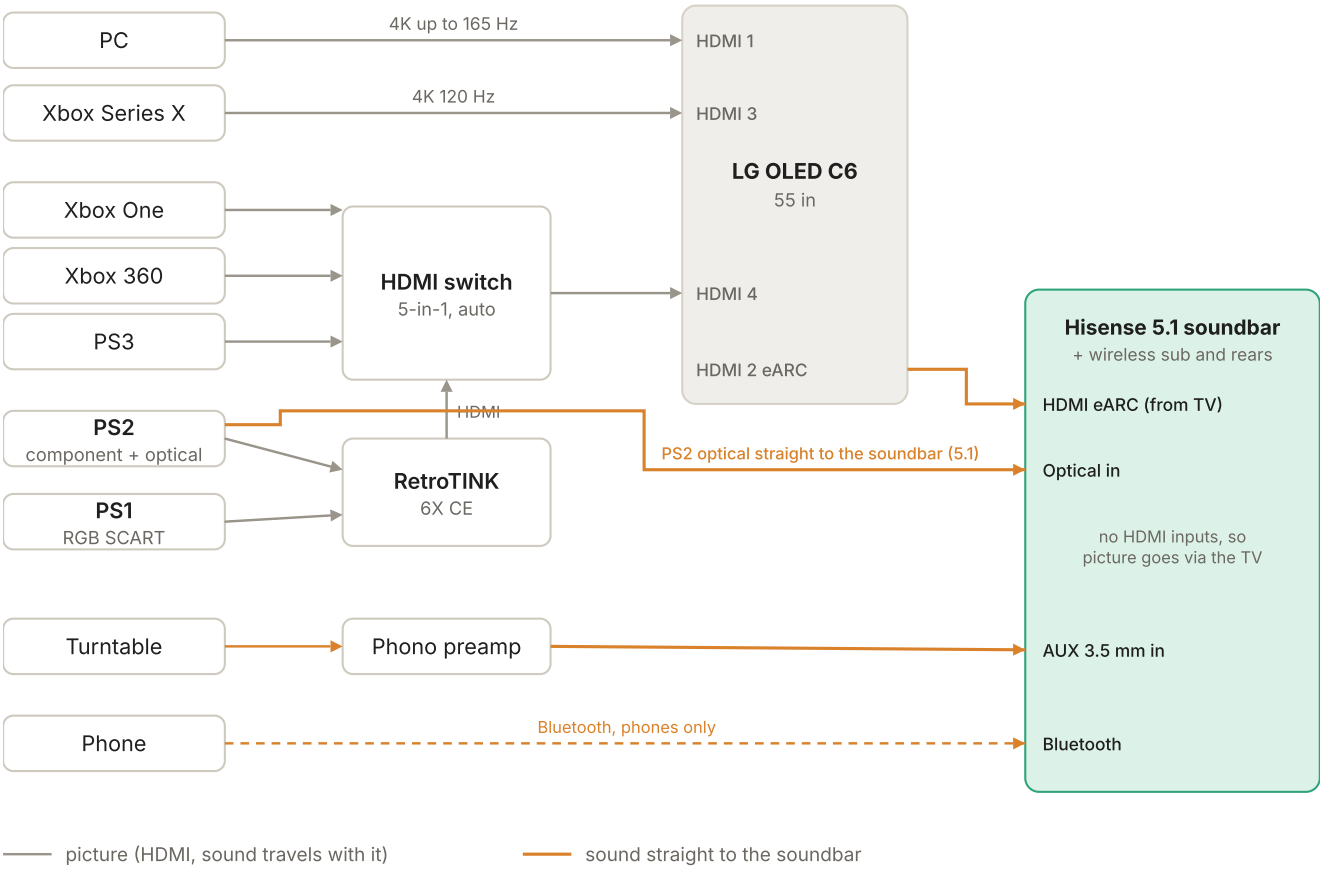
Cabling rules

- Solid pure-copper Cat6, round; not CCA or flat cable for the long runs. Measure the real route and add 2–3 m.
- Cross mains at right angles; never staple through a cable; no kinks; label both ends. Never two cables between the same two devices.
- **Done when:** Deco B and C show "Ethernet", each PC shows 1.0 Gbps, the Xbox shows NAT: Open, and phones hold a strong signal in the kitchen and across the living room.

AV: everything sounds through the Hisense

Everything sounds through the Hisense: directly where it can, via the TV where it can't

The soundbar has no HDMI inputs, so HDMI sources reach it over eARC; vinyl, PS2 audio and phones go straight in



Source	Picture	Sound
PC · Xbox Series X	TV HDMI 1 · HDMI 3	Via the TV over eARC (5.1 or Atmos)
Xbox One, Xbox 360, PS3	HDMI switch → TV HDMI 4	Via the TV over eARC, 5.1
PS2	Component → RetroTINK → switch → TV	Optical straight to the soundbar
PS1	RGB SCART → RetroTINK → switch → TV	Stereo through the RetroTINK and eARC
Turntable · phone	—	Preamp → AUX · Bluetooth

TV settings: rename the inputs (HDMI 4 "Retro"), Deep Colour on HDMI 1, 3 and 4, Game Optimiser on the console inputs, sound out to HDMI eARC. RetroTINK-6X CE: a 5 V 2 A USB plug on the retro 6-way; the PS2's Component Video Out set to Y Cb/Pb Cr/Pr; RGB SCART for the PS1.

10 · Build guide, for a first-time builder

Everything to build is in the **Build Guide** (its own PDF): one chapter per thing you make, each with its buy list, its cutting diagram and its steps.

Ch.	In the guide	Time
1	The media wall base	2–3 days
2	The oak worktop	½ day
3	The oak uprights and shelves	2–3 days
4	The side-wall run and the PC shelf	1 day
5	The dining cabinet and table	3–4 days
6	The bar	1 day
7	The glass case	½ day
8	The record table	½ day
9	Bought and fitted: shelves, cabinets, the door shelf	1 day
A	The network	2 h
B	Cables and the socket	2–3 days
C	Paint	2–3 days
D	Lighting	1 day
E	Connect and finish	1 day

11 · Buy list and tracker

Every purchase and job, in build order, comes to about £4,382–8,260, with no electrician on top: the electrics are your own job, and the tools for them are on the list. Each phase carries its part's coloured label. Estimates are approximate UK prices; changed and new items are marked. Tick items off and write in what you paid.

Cost overview: each piece and what to buy for it

Qty	To buy	About
The media wall		**£1,177–2,202**
2 ×	IKEA BESTÅ frame, 60 × 40 × 64	£70–200
4 ×	IKEA BESTÅ shelf, 56 × 36	£12–32
1 ×	Plinth frame, 18 mm ply	£15–30
1 ×	Plinth drawer: oak front, ply box, runners	£30–50
1 ×	Bay 3 carcass, 18 mm birch ply	£50–90
2 ×	Face-out LP crate: ply, oak lip, runners	£120–200
3 ×	Slim game drawer: ply, oak lip, runners	£70–130
1 ×	Game drawer: ply, soft-close runners	£50–90
1 ×	Sub riser and ply divider	£25–45
1 set	Anti-tip brackets and spacers	£15–25
2 ×	Solid oak upright, 165 × 30 × 4.5	£150–300
1 set	Solid oak for the shelves and the side-wall run	£230–380
1 ×	Solid oak worktop, 300 × 62	£250–450
1 ×	Oak face frame, 186 cm	£60–120
1 set	Oak wedges, dowel, concealed brackets	£30–60
The side wall and the PC		**£95–210**
1 ×	Keyboard tray: oak housing, ply tray, runners	£25–45
1 set	Oval conduit, 38 and 25 mm, and a 5 m C13 lead	£15–35
1 ×	Wall chaser for a day, and filler	£20–45
1 ×	PC tidy kit: sleeve, grommet	£5–15
1 ×	Powered 4-port USB 3 hub	£15–30
1 ×	Remote PC power button	£10–30
1 ×	Magnetic dust filter	£5–10
The dining cabinet		**£1,026–1,735**
1 set	Oak-faced ply, cut to size: two boxes, two doors	£230–410
1 set	Solid oak for the table, two 92.5 × 90 halves	£265–460
1 set	Oak: hinge rail, aprons, four legs, door stops	£35–70

1 ×	Piano hinge, 1800 × 50 (the table)	£16–20
1 set	Two door piano hinges, catches, magnet, hooks	£35–65
1 set	Folding leg brackets (4), tabletop fasteners (16)	£60–75
3 ×	Lee Valley flip-top hinge	£25–45
3 pairs	Grey padded folding chairs (Brayden Studio)	£240–390
1 set	The bar: oak-faced ply cupboard, oak counter, hinges	£70–120
1 set	Over the bar: IKEA ENHET frame, mirror, glass rail, LED	£50–80
The chimney breast		**£100–195**
1 set	Glass case: 4 mm toughened front, three 6 mm shelves, cut to size	£70–130
1 set	Glass case: oak frame, oak-faced ply back, pins, cleat, LED strip	£20–40
1 ×	“Now playing” oak ledge and brackets	£10–25
Lighting		**£288–795**
2 ×	Dunelm Wolston 4-light spot bar	£98–110
8 ×	Smart colour E14 bulb	£100–360
1 set	Smart colour LED strip, 4.5 m, with channels	£90–220
1 ×	Smart scene button (optional)	£0–25
1 ×	Ceiling strip channel and diffuser (later)	£0–80
Paint		**£220–540**
1 lot	Farrow & Ball Card Room Green: emulsion, eggshell, primer	£200–500
1 set	Woodwork primer, sanding pads, sugar soap	£20–40
Network		**£111–190**
2 ×	TP-Link TL-SG108 8-port switch	£36–50
11 ×	Cat6 patch lead, 0.5–2 m	£15–20
2–4 runs	Cat6 solid copper cable	£30–60
1 set	Cat6 tools: punch-down, keystones, tester, draw rods	£30–60
Electrics (your own job)		**£70–145**
1 ×	Double socket and back box	£5–15
1 set	Safety kit: GS38 tester, lock-off, socket tester	£45–90
1 set	Insulated screwdrivers, strippers, cutters	£20–40
Power and cables		**£65–115**
1 ×	6-way surge-protected extension	£20–35
1 ×	4-port USB charger	£10–20
1 ×	USB plug, 5 V 2 A	£5–10
1 set	Cable kit: grommets, velcro ties, labels	£20–30
1 ×	Flat trunking, 2 m	£10–20

TV, consoles and AV		**£288–420**
1 ×	RetroTINK-6X upscaler	£200–240
1 ×	5-in-1 4K HDMI switch	£20–35
1 ×	Active optical HDMI cable, 5 m	£20–60
5 + 2	HDMI lead, 1–2 m, and 90° adapters	£25–40
1 ×	PS2 component cable	£10–20
1 ×	Optical cable, 2 m	£5–10
1 ×	PS1 RGB SCART cable	£8–15
Vinyl kit		**£80–190**
1 ×	Replacement stylus	£15–40
1 ×	Phono preamp (only if needed)	£40–100
1 ×	RCA to 3.5 mm lead, 2 m	£5–10
1 set	Isolation feet and a record brush	£20–40
Your picks		**£401–552**
2 ×	IKEA EKET wall cabinet, 35 cube, glass door	£70–100
2 ×	Oak floating shelf, 900 × 230	£70–110
1 set	Oak shelf over the door, two KUGGIS boxes	£35–60
2 ×	IKEA KUGGIS box, 35 × 26 × 15	£20–30
1 ×	Blanket basket, water hyacinth, 59 × 51 × 29	£36–42
1 set	Record table: two KALLAX, oak lid, ply base, castors	£170–210
Finishing touches		**£13–26**
1 ×	Drip trays for the plant stand	£10–20
1 set	Felt pads	£3–6
Can wait (after you move in)		**£440–930**
1 ×	Storage ottoman, navy velvet, 76 × 76 (ISTOOLS)	£140–310
1 ×	Rug, about 230 × 160	£120–300
1 set	Step drawers: ply boxes, oak fronts, runners	£180–320
Other		**£8–15**
1 set	The C-table	£8–15
All of it		**£4,382–8,260**

12 · Other options and sources

Not in the plan or the costs. Each one is a switch in the 3D room (Room, Try options); ask for a build by name.

Option	Where	Size (cm)	About £
A bar under the glass case[67,49]	Chimney breast, under the case	90 × 39.1 × 20	80–130
A slim drinks trolley[56]	Beside the dining cabinet	20 × 43.2 × 86.5	36–70
A bar by the sofa[67]	Side wall at the sofa's open end	60 × 39 × 20	60–100
The lidded seagrass basket[75]	Sofa's open end	45 × 45 × 76	90–110
An oak blanket rail[78]	Beside the dining cabinet	45 wide, 12 off the wall	25–45
A tall mirror[57]	Beside the dining cabinet	40 × 150	25
A low oak shelf for plates[58]	Beside the dining cabinet	52.6 × 23.4 × 76	40–70
Two shoe cabinets[94]	Beside the dining cabinet	two 52 × 18 × 39	25–30
A lift-top coffee table[76]	Coffee table's place	90 × 50 × 48	39–80
A storage window seat[97]	Window corner	98 × 46 × 45	160–280
A bench with cubbies[98]	Your hall, or the window corner	104 × 30 × 48	80–130
A built-in cupboard[99]	Window corner, floor to ceiling	100 × 60	450–800
A hook rail over the door[100]	Over the hall door	49 × 11 × 14	12–25
An 80-wide table[62]	The dining cabinet	137.2 long; four chairs inside, not six	about the same
A smooth or patterned ceiling[103,104]	The ceiling (test the Artex first)	the whole ceiling	200–700
Oak-effect beams, coffers or an LED cove[105,106]	The ceiling	12 × 12 beams; cove 2 m lengths	450–1,050
Grow-light bars[110]	Under the plant stand's tiers	four 30 cm bars	45–60
Curtain motors (Film closes them)[111]	On the curtain pole	two, 8.4 × 7.3 × 20.5	160–200
Two LP ledges, covers face-out[112]	Side wall over the sofa, 108 up	two 55 × 12	12–14
A cordless lamp[113]	On the C-table	31 tall, 14 across	20–25
Easy-care plants (Look: Plants)[88]	The stand and the sill	snake plants and pothos in 12 cm pots	9–15 each

One pot finish for all (Look: Pots)[86]	The stand, the sill, the shelf	about 23 pots, 12–24 cm	3–8 each
Self-watering inserts[87]	The stand's bigger pots	15 across, 1.2 litres, in a 16–17 pot	7 each
Decor to try (20 pieces)	Round the room	typical shop sizes	542–1,165 together
Small ideas (8)	Round the room	drawn to the room	285–545 together

Sources

Numbered sources are the item sizes used in the fit proof (section 3).

1. Your hand-measured sketch of the living room, in mm (alcove 1860 × 380, chimney breast 1175, ceiling 2350)
2. LG: OLED55C6 specifications: 1222 × 703 × 45.1 mm without stand, 1222 × 757 × 230 mm with stand, stand 470 × 230 mm, 14.1/15.9 kg, VESA 300 × 200 (lg.com, OLED55C6 product pages)
3. Trusted Reviews and Expert Reviews, Hisense AX5100G reviews: soundbar 920 × 60 × 90 mm, subwoofer 214 × 294 × 304 mm (W × H × D) with a rear-firing port, rear speakers 90 × 144 × 109 mm
4. Wikipedia, Xbox Series X: 151 × 151 × 301 mm; Pure Xbox (Nov 2020) quoting Microsoft: at least 4 cm clear above the console on an open stand, 10–15 cm recommended on all sides
5. IKEA: BESTÅ frame 60 × 40 × 64 cm (10247379); BESTÅ shelf 56 × 36 cm, 20 kg maximum load
6. TP-Link: TL-SG108 specifications, 158 × 101 × 25 mm (tp-link.com)
7. Laptop Outlet: TP-Link Deco X1500 3-pack listing, 110 × 110 × 114 mm per unit
8. Audio-Technica: AT-LP120XUSB specifications, 452 × 352 × 141.6 mm, 8 kg without dust cover (audio-technica.com)
9. RetroTINK: RetroTINK-6X CE shop page (power 5 V 2 A by USB; no size published)
10. UGREEN: 5-in-1 4K60 HDMI switch CM568 (90512), 127 × 59 × 25 mm
11. Original Xbox One power supply: 17 × 7.5 × 4.8 cm (6.69 × 2.96 × 1.88 in), as listed by several replacement-PSU sellers
12. Wikipedia: Comparison of PlayStation consoles (PS1 270 × 188 × 60, PS2 302 × 183 × 78, PS3 325 × 274 × 98 mm); Xbox One (333 × 274 × 79 mm); Neowin: official Xbox 360 dimensions (309 × 258 × 83 mm)
13. Record and case sizes: LP sleeve 31.4 cm (12⅜ in); 7-inch sleeve 18.3–18.4 cm; DVD-style keep case 19 × 13.5 × 1.4 cm; Xbox One case 17 × 13.5 × 1.1–1.2 cm (videogamecasesize.info; Walvis Products; Wikipedia: Keep case)
14. Dunelm: Elements Wolston 4-light spotlight bar, £49: 84 × 16 cm, 22.4 cm drop, shades 15 cm, E14 6 W max (dunelm.com, product 1000189449)
15. Emuca heavy-duty full-extension runners, 400 mm, 68 kg per pair; Accuride DZ3832EC 350 mm, 43 kg; runner fitting allowance 12.5 mm a side
16. Xbox 360 original 203 W power supply: no Microsoft size published; Akyga's 203 W replacement for it (AK-PD-14) is 210 × 77 × 55 mm (b2b.akyga.com), so an allowance of 21 × 10 × 6 cm is used here (measure yours)
17. Turntable Lab: Audio-Technica replacement dust cover for the AT-LP120XUSB (705-140XP-1815), 17.375 × 13.625 × 2.75 in (44.1 × 34.6 × 7.0 cm)
18. Häfele UK, Technology catalogue 2023, p. 7.206: Hebgo heavy-duty folding bracket 287.43.428, arm 580 mm, height 220 mm, 500 kg per pair, locks automatically when raised; up to 800 mm between brackets (Häfele 287.43.419 listing)
19. Screwfix: Union PowerLoad lift-off hinges, 100 × 88 mm, 3-pack (5938T), 120 kg maximum door weight
20. Emuca: table legs Ø60 mm, 710 mm, height adjustable 710–730 mm, 50 kg per leg (set of 4): 710 is the standard dining leg; the plan's oak legs are made to the same 71 cm
21. RS PRO 45 mm steel spring clip (RS 175-3588): 42.1 × 56 × 12.7 mm, packs of 10 (uk.rs-online.com)
22. IKEA: TERJE folding chair, 43 W × 49 D × 78 H cm, seat height 48 cm, tested for 110 kg
23. Book a Builder UK, small dining room ideas: 600 mm of table edge per diner; table edge to a wall 600 mm tight minimum, 750 mm to aim for, 1000–1100 mm to walk behind; dining height about 750 mm
24. Your photo of the sofa (18 Oct 2026) and your note (21 Oct): a blue corduroy L-sofa, two seats then the corner on the long side, which ends about 40 cm short of the window's west end (about 266 cm long); the return's 168 is a typical corner-sofa size until measured
25. Klipsch subwoofer placement guidance, as quoted by Cloudspress and TechYorker (2026): leave about 6–12 in (15–30 cm) between a rear-firing port and the nearest obstruction
26. Xbox Support (Microsoft), About the Xbox One power supply (archived): don't block its vents, don't put it in a confined space such as a bookcase, rack or stereo cabinet unless the space is well ventilated, don't stack devices on it, and lay it flat on its four rubber pads; the Xbox 360 brick's advice is the same

27. Xbox Support (Microsoft), Xbox 360 placement tips, as quoted on Gaming Stack Exchange: an open, well-ventilated area, a hard surface, and away from high-vibrating sources such as subwoofers
28. Your two photos of the west end (20 Oct 2026): the 2 m black shelf on the wall beside the stairs, scaled from its 2 m: it starts about 41 cm past the stair box and stops about 16 cm short of the window corner, top about 200; the pendant hangs about 55 cm out from the wall, a quarter of the way along it
29. Corsair 4000D Airflow, a typical mid-tower gaming case: 453 × 230 × 466 mm (TechPowerUp review)
30. Lee Valley: 40574 narrow flip-top hinges, solid brass, 1/2 in × 2 3/4 in (1.27 × 7.0 cm), for card and flip-top tables (leevalley.com); their 40208 card-table hinge is 1 3/16 in (3.0 cm) wide, too wide for a 27 mm edge
31. Your photo (20 Oct) and note: Dunelm hessian pencil-pleat curtains; Dunelm pencil-pleat drops run 137, 182 and 228 cm with a 3 in header; Dunelm 28 mm wooden poles, 120–360 cm, rings included (one per 10 cm), finials up to 8 cm more (dunelm.com)
32. Your plant stand, from the listing you sent (20 Oct): 98 × 29.5 × 158 cm (W × D × H), slatted wood; two five-tier towers with an open middle holding two shelves
33. Your vinyl stand, from the listing you sent (20 Oct): 70 × 32 × 78 cm (W × D × H), 63 to where the frame slopes; two top bays 32.3 wide split by a wooden divider, a 10 cm front board, wire dividers 19.5 tall on the bottom shelf; black steel and rustic wood
34. IKEA: OBEGRÄNSAD LED wall lamp, black (your 905.262.63; 005.262.48 and others by country): 52 × 36 × 6 cm, 5 W, five lighting programmes, hangs landscape or portrait, runs on a 5 V USB-A adapter sold separately (ikea.com); its face is a 16 × 16 grid of white LEDs. From the Swedish House Mafia collection (IKEA press kit, Sept 2022)
35. Sony: DualSense controller 160 × 66 × 106 mm (W × H × D); Microsoft: Xbox Wireless Controller 153 × 61 × 104 mm
36. Record-shop browser crates and LP storage boxes are made about 32.5–33 cm inside for 31.4 cm sleeves (31.8–32.4 in outer sleeves), flipped by the sleeves' top edges
37. Philips Hue Lightstrip Plus V4: 2 m base kit, cuttable every 33 cm, extendable with 1 m; WiZ Wi-Fi LED strip, 2 m starter kit, cuttable; both RGB and tunable white, in the same apps as the bars' bulbs (philips-hue.com; wizconnected.com)
38. Smart colour E14 bulbs for the bars: WiZ Colour P45 E14, 4.9 W, 4.5 × 10.1 cm, Wi-Fi, no hub (Philips UK specification sheet, 8719514437333); Philips Hue White and Colour Ambiance E14 lustre, 5.1 W, 45 × 77 mm (Philips Hue; Lampmasters)
39. IKEA UK: FRÖSVI folding chair, beech, £20 (705.343.15): solid beech, a slatted seat with no cushion, 44 W × 51 D × 77 H, seat 38 × 33 at 46 high, tested for 110 kg, a hanging hole in the back; its package 44 × 9 × 89 cm, 2.89 kg (no folded size is published). The padded version, white with a Knisa cover (805.343.34, £30), is 43 × 49 × 78, seat 48 (ikea.com/gb product pages, 21 Oct 2026)
40. Screwfix: Smith & Locke Mid Duty Anti-Slip Storage Hook, 200 × 200 mm, steel, 60 kg maximum load, £3.59 (8882J); FRÖSVI padded weighs 3.61 kg net (ikea.com.tw)
41. Buller Ltd: Folding Heavy Duty Bracket for Bench and Tables, 330 mm long, 82 mm wide, steel, grey primed, automatic lock when raised, 50 mm proud of the wall folded, 150 kg per pair (75 kg each), brackets at most 800 mm apart (bullerltd.co.uk)
42. Client, 20 Oct 2026: the sofa's ottoman, square, blue corduroy matching the sofa, "the size of a chair on the sofa": one seat, 75 × 75; its height taken at the seat's 44 until measured
43. IronmongeryDirect: Altro continuous piano hinge, 1800 × 50 × 1.2 mm, satin 304 stainless steel, £16.00 (SKU 302829; cut to length, screwed every 10 cm) (ironmongerydirect.co.uk)
44. ManoMano UK: folding, self-locking table-leg brackets, 75 × 60 × 55 mm, set of four with screws, about £58: lock at 90°, for legs at least 2½ in (6.4 cm) at the top; seller's rating 226.8 kg a bracket (manomano.co.uk, listing 219621358)
45. Clever (Italy): Slim fold-down table in a wall unit: folded 80 × 9 × 138 cm, open 80 × 138 × 74, a 1.8 cm top (clever.it): the same idea, a top hinged at its foot that stands up into the wall
46. Blum CLIP top 170° full-overlay hinge, self-closing (71T6540; cabinetparts.com): doors open past flat, so they lie back against the cabinet's front while you take the chairs out
47. Häfele UK catalogue 10.054, Slido Classic 40 IF C (files.hafele.co.uk/catalogfiles/www/16a10-54.pdf; NBS Source): two bypassing wooden doors inset in the carcass, top hung; doors 16–19 mm thick, up to 40 kg, 2200 tall and 1250 wide; fitting set for two doors with soft close 402.33.027; double top track for a 16 mm groove 402.33.652 (2.5 m, needs a top panel of 19 mm or more); bottom guide track 402.30.802 in a 6 mm groove. The track's section isn't published: the plan allows 5 cm of depth for it and the two doors
48. Client, 20 Oct 2026: "my surround speakers … exist standing behind the sofa", two photos of the room, and "they are directly behind the sofa on the left and right ends": the AX5100G's own rears, one behind each end of the sofa's long side, the speakers just above the sofa's back (scaled against its 80 cm in the photo); the stands' base drawn 11 cm square
49. IronmongeryDirect: Altro continuous piano hinge, 1800 × 32 × 1 mm, satin 304 stainless steel, £9.50 (SKU 517299): 16 mm leaves, so each fits on an 18 mm door's edge; one a door, full height. No load rating is published

50. Client, 21 Oct 2026: "the wall on the stairs is solid. electrics done ourselves"; and "i just need a smaller build on the cabinet if we can", "they dont particularly need to be oak chairs", "show me both versions for the cabinet"
51. Dunelm: Esme Washed Cotton Square Seat Pad, £9: 40 × 40 × 3 cm, ties, recycled polyester fill, 100% cotton cover, wipe clean; Blue, Honey, Ivory, Olive or Rose Pink (dunelm.com, product 1000279425)
52. IKEA UK: ÄNGSFRÄKEN chair pad, £4: round, 36 cm across, 3.0 cm thick, an anti-slip back and a hanging loop (no ties), machine wash 40°C; black, blue, brown-red or dark beige (ikea.com/gb)
53. IKEA UK: BRÄMÖN chair pad, £2 (504.846.65): 34 × 34 × 1.0 cm, ties, grey-beige, indoors or out (ikea.com/gb)
54. Habitat: Wooden Folding Chair, Light Wood, £21: open H79 × W42.5 × D47.5, seat 38 × 37 at 45; "packs away flat to just 7cm deep" (H87 × W43 × D7 folded) (habitat.co.uk, product 5548794)
55. Anonima Castelli Plia folding chair (Made in Design UK, £325): W46.9 × H88.8, 5.4 cm thick folded; steel and polycarbonate
56. VASAGLE 4-Tier Slim Kitchen Storage Trolley with Wheels, £35.99: 20 × 43.2 × 86.5 cm, particleboard and steel, rustic white and honey brown (songmicshome.co.uk, UKLRC050)
57. IKEA UK: NISSEDAL mirror, 40 × 150 cm, black (906.054.82) or white (706.054.83), £25 (was £30) (ikea.com/gb)
58. Dinner plates: IKEA FÄRGKLAR plate 26 cm (ikea.lt, 904.781.77); IKEA 365+ dinner plate 27 cm (dimensions.com)
59. Online Lighting: Slimline Medium Battery Operated LED Picture Light, satin nickel, £14.99 (166342): overall H 77 × W 279 × D 125 mm, shade H 16 × W 279 × D 16 mm, back plate H 70 × W 106 mm, three AA cells (onlinelighting.co.uk)
60. The Range: Made to Measure Blackout Roller Blind, from £24.99: width 10–240 cm, drop 10–210 cm, made to the size given, inside or outside the recess on top- or face-fix brackets (therange.co.uk)
61. Dickens Direct: 40cm USB Rechargeable LED Under Cabinet Light, wireless, motion sensor and touch, warm white (3000K), magnetic or adhesive fixing, £13.99 ex. VAT (PCJW256; dickensdirect.com)
62. Wayfair UK (Brayden Studio), sent by you: "2PCS Wooden Folding Dining Chair with Cushion, Padded Seat, Grey Breathable Linen Fabric, 6.5cm Thick Cushion, 110° Backrest, 168kg Capacity, No Assembly"; "a generously sized 47×47cm seat paired with a 6.5cm thick high-density sponge cushion. 90×10×47cm" (folded: 90 tall, 10 thick, 47 wide); listing u111353306; your photo of a pair (media-wall/inputs/chairs_padded_listing_photo.webp): bent-wood sides, buttoned seat and back
63. Costway: set of 2 wooden folding dining chairs with linen padded seat and backrest (53981642), the like-for-like chair the padded chairs' open depth, height and seat height are drawn at: 19 × 24 × 31 in (48.3 W × 61 D × 78.7 H cm), seat 17.5 in high (44.5), seat 16 × 17.5 in, folding size 19 × 36.5 in (48.3 × 92.7); 300 lb a chair; no folded thickness published (costway.com, 21 Oct 2026)
64. FHB Rundle (UK): custom-sized toughened glass panels, cut to your sizes, polished on all edges with docked corners, 0.3 m² minimum charged (fhbrundle.co.uk); toughened glass about £70–90 a m², polished edges about £5 a m² more (UK glass cost calculator, everycalculators.com)
65. Simply Plastics (UK): silver acrylic mirror sheet cut to size, ±1 mm, 3 mm (5 mm advised over 1200 × 1200) (simplyplastics.com)
66. 70 cl spirit bottles, makers' sheets: Univerre Platin 70 cl 349 tall × 74.0 across; Univerre Oblò bartop 192 × 94.7; Univerre London 238 × 92.0; Saverglass Premiere Spirit 70 cl 327.5 × 76.2; Verallia Caeli 700 ml 263.9 × 74.7 (univerre.ch, saverglass.com, uk.verallia.com)
67. Howdens: Blum soft-close flap stay, pack of two, steel, for doors 14–22 mm thick (HKE0069; howdens.com); a stay is sized by torque, half the flap's height × its weight (Sugatsune soft-down stays, global.sugatsune.com)
68. ISTOOLS (UK): Large Velvet Storage Ottoman, square, a lift-off upholstered lid on a memory-foam pad, a solid wooden frame, legs that screw on; 14 sizes from 48 × 43 to 120 × 120, among them 76 × 76 (30 × 30 in, "a small-flat coffee table"); blues include navy; the 76 × 76 listed at £304 on one of their velvet ottomans; height not given (istools.co.uk/products/square-plain-lid-coffee-table-ottoman-storage-large-velvet-footrest-ukw)
69. Dunelm: Square Opulent Velvet Storage Footstool, H 39 × W 62 × D 62 cm, legs 3.5, storage inside H 18 × 57.5 × 57.5, nine colours including navy, £139.30–199 (dunelm.com, product 1000249916)
70. Dunelm: Zoe Pinstripe Fabric Square Storage Footstool, H 49 × W 96 × D 96 cm, cotton blend, tested to 120 kg, navy among its colours, £199 (£99.50 in a sale) (dunelm.com, product 1000239490)
71. Homebase: Luxor Navy Blue Jumbo Cord Footstool, 55 × 55, 45 high (42 on diy.com), a fixed top, no storage, £136 (homebase.co.uk, 0739873)
72. Wikipedia, Ticket to Ride (board game): its box is 30 × 30 × 8 cm, and became a common reference size for medium-size games; a retailer lists the 2023 Days of Wonder box at 30 × 30 × 7.6 (en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Ticket_to_Ride_(board_game))
73. Kaufland (Austria): Bicycle Botanica playing cards, packaging 65 × 92 × 18 mm; Bicycle's poker-size cards are 88 × 63 mm (kaufland.at/product/400400869)
74. IKEA: OFELIA throw, 130 × 170 cm, white: package 38 × 33 × 8 cm, 0.67 kg, as sold folded (ikea.com/lv/en/p/ofelia-throw-white-50613224)

75. The Cotswold Company: Seagrass Basket With Lid, Large: 76 high × 45 wide × 45 deep (external), handwoven seagrass, £99 (cotswoldco.com/homeware/storage/baskets-and-general-storage/seagrass-basket-with-lid-large)
76. Sports Direct: Homelife Lifting Traditional Coffee Table, H48 × W90 × D50 cm, 53.5 high with the top lifted, a storage area inside, £39 (was £79.99) (sportsdirect.com/homelife-lifting-traditional-coffee-table-946062)
77. IKEA: KUGGIS box with lid, 26 × 35 × 15 cm, recycled PET with a bamboo lid; fits storage at least 26 deep (ikea.com.tr/en/p09610214)
78. Tools & Timber: oak dowels, 18 to 30 mm across, cut from 350 to 2400 mm long (toolsandtimber.co.uk/oak-dowels)
79. Dibor: Lakelyn Water Hyacinth Lined Basket, large H59 × W51 × D29 cm (medium H48 × W41 × D21), water hyacinth with a removable cotton lining, natural, £42 (dibor.co.uk/products/lakelyn-water-hyacinth-lined-basket); no lid listed
80. IKEA: KALLAX cube storage unit, 42 × 42 cm, grey wood effect (also white, black-brown, white stained oak effect): W 41.5 × D 39 × H 40.7 cm, 13 kg a shelf, £19 (ikea.com/gb/en/p/kallax-shelving-unit-grey-wood-effect-60477933); open-backed, a 33 cm square compartment
81. Snowdon Timber: oak furniture board, 18 × 600 × 1200 mm, £184.50 for a pack of three through Tesco Marketplace (tesco.com/shop/en-GB/products/326112258), single boards from snowdontimber.co.uk
82. Wickes: non-structural hardwood plywood sheet, 12 × 607 × 1829 mm, £22.50 (wickes.co.uk, product 112957)
83. Toolstation: MOVE IT swivel wheel castor, 50 mm, non-marking rubber tyre, 50 kg each, £3.29 (toolstation.com/swivel-wheel-castor/p29715); about 6.5 high overall (check the listing)
84. Eurofit Direct: toy box and lid stays, soft-down, for ottomans and toy boxes, £14.90 each or £29.81 a pair (eurofitdirect.co.uk/collections/toy-box-and-lid-stays)
85. Your photo of the stairs (23 Oct 2026, inputs/photo_stairs_banister_23oct.jpg): a square newel post at the foot, two flat slats raking up from it to the wall by the door, no spindles; a low white wall with a capping under them
86. IKEA UK: PERSILLADE plant pot, 12 cm, £3 (003.157.26); the range runs to 24 cm (ikea.com/gb)
87. elho: self-watering insert, 15 cm across, 12 cm high, holds 1.2 litres, for a 16–17 cm pot, £6.99 (elho.com)
88. Boma Garden Centre: Sansevieria trifasciata 'Laurentii', 12 cm pot, £14.99; Gardening Express: variegated snake plant, 12 cm pot, 30–50 cm tall, £8.99 on offer
89. Farrow & Ball: Estate Emulsion covers up to 14 m² a litre a coat (70 m² per 5 L), two coats recommended (farrow-ball.com paint calculator; DIY.ie listing, 35 m² per 2.5 L)
90. IKEA: ENHET wall frame with shelves, 40 × 15 × 75 cm, anthracite or white, steel, two shelves, 3 kg a shelf, to be anchored to the wall; about 32–39 € (ikea.com/th 404.816.05; islas.ikea.es 304.489.37)
91. Client, 22 Oct 2026: "The shelf on the wall alongside the stairs must always end 10cm short of the right-hand wall, regardless of any other sizing or positioning logic. It should never touch the right wall … it reflects how the shelf is actually installed" (facing the stairs wall, the right-hand wall at the shelf's height is the pipe boxing's side)
92. Homebuilding & Renovating: the UK's usual worktop height is 900 mm to the top (homebuilding.co.uk/advice/kitchen-worktop-height); a raised bar counter 1000 to 1200
93. Stemmed wine glasses, makers' sizes: Rosendahl Grand Cru red 20.5 and 22.2 tall; CB2 Joplin 22.9; most 20 to 23 (culinaris.de, cb2.ca, dimensions.com)
94. IKEA UK: TRONES shoe cabinet/storage, white, 52 × 18 × 39 cm, a pack of two £25, about four pairs each; must be fixed to the wall (ikea.com/gb, 003.973.07)
95. IKEA: EKET wall cabinet with glass door, 35 × 35 × 35 cm, a suspension rail included, at least 5 cm to the ceiling; about 38 € (ikea.com/lv, ikea.com/cz)
96. B&Q: Shelf Depot oak floating shelf, L 900 × D 230 mm, a concealed steel bracket included (diy.com, 5060042781980); Wickes floating shelf brackets for solid walls
97. Window seats: a seat 17 to 19 in (43 to 48 cm) high and at least 16 in (41 cm) deep, 18 to 22 in better (hunker.com, askthebuilder.com); a lift-up lid stores the most
98. notonthehighstreet (Momentum): open-compartments shoe bench, 104 × 30 × 48 cm, a padded seat, 200 kg on the seat
99. FCI London: built-in wardrobes need 60 cm for a hanging rail (under 60, no standard rail); sliding doors 66 plus about 5 for the track (fcilondon.co.uk/blog/how-deep-should-built-in-wardrobes-be)
100. Linen Chest: metal over-door hanger, six hooks, 49 × 11 × 14 cm; UK-door racks fit doors 2.5 to 4.5 cm thick (linenchest.com; RISEMART, latestdeals.co.uk)
101. The Day: building drawers into a staircase, the usable size set by the stringers and the treads; UK Workshop: each tread needs support once its riser is cut (theday.com/?p=192887; ukworkshop.co.uk/threads/understair-storage.151071)
102. SanMar: a structured six-panel cap's spec sheet, bill (visor) 2¾ in (7 cm), crown 6¾ in measured over the top (sanmar.com, 72788); the client's photo of their cap, 22 Oct 2026 (green crown, brown brim, gold embroidery)
103. Trade2Base, Plastering Costs UK 2026: skim coat £150–£350 a room, Artex removal (or skimming over it) £300–£700 a room, plasterers' day rates about £180–£300 (trade2base.com/blog/plastering-costs-uk)

L04. Supernova Asbestos Surveys: Artex asbestos testing kit, £34.99 with PPE, a UK-accredited lab's result in 48 hours; Artex made before about 1985 can hold chrysotile, so don't sand, scrape or drill it until you know (asbestos-surveys.org.uk/shop/testing-kit/artex)

L05. Woodmosaic: PU faux wood ceiling beam, 12 × 12 cm, lengths 100, 195, 295 and 395 cm, 1–4 kg, £62–£349 by length (woodmosaic.co.uk/pu-faux-wood-beam-fake-wooden-decorative-ceiling-beams-false)

L06. Mr Resistor: Orac C357 uplighting coving profile for LED tape, 2000 mm, £89.60 (mr-resistor.co.uk/product/28207); fitted LED coving in a typical UK room £350–£700 (coving.online, LED coving cost, 2026)

L07. PlazCutz (UK): 400 mm × 200 mm × 6 mm mild steel plate, S275, £3.57 incl. VAT (plazcutz.com/store/400mm-x-200mm-x-6mm-Mild-Steel-Plate-S275-p860680992); 6 mm steel weighs 47 kg/m², so 3.77 kg

L08. The Wood Database: European oak (Quercus robur), average dried weight 710 kg/m³ (wood-database.com/english-oak)

L09. Bought C-tables, compared: a C-shaped side table 48 × 61 × 30 cm, £25.99 (pricespy.co.uk/s/c-shape-table); GVAwood's oak C-shaped side table 50 × 30 × 65 cm (gvawood.com). Both steady themselves with a foot that slides under the sofa

L10. Spider Farmer UK: GlowBar 1FT full-spectrum LED grow light strips, 4 pack, linkable, 30 cm long, £44.99 (spiderfarmer.co.uk/products/1ft-full-spectrum-led-grow-light-strips-for-indoor-plants)

L11. SwitchBot UK: Curtain 3 Rod Type 1, 84 × 73 × 205 mm, 572 g, for 10–40 mm rods and curtains up to 15 kg, £99.99 (£80.00 on offer) (uk.switch-bot.com/products/switchbot-curtain-3-rod-type-1)

L12. IKEA UK: MOSSLANDA picture ledge, oak effect, 55 cm: length 55, depth 12, max. load 5 kg, £6 (115 cm £7 more) (ikea.com/gb, 805.898.35)

L13. Habitat (Argos): Rechargeable Mushroom LED Table Lamp, taupe: overall H31 × W14 cm, shade H7 × D14, base 9 across, £20 (habitat.co.uk/product/7275773)

L14. Virgin Media: Hub 5 modem mode

L15. RetroTINK: Introducing the RetroTINK-6X CE (inputs including TOSLINK, deinterlacing); RetroTINK-2X Pro listed as legacy; RetroTINK-4K CE

L16. Expert Reviews: LG C6 OLED review (4 × HDMI 2.1, one eARC, ports on the left); JB Hi-Fi: LG C6 specifications (165 Hz mode for PC sources)

L17. Hisense AX5100G spec sheet (inputs, auto power-on); JB Hi-Fi Business: AX5100G (rears linked by cable, wireless to the soundbar)

L18. TP-Link: Deco X1500 specifications (two gigabit ports per unit)

L19. Glorious Vinyl Vault specifications (80 LPs and 24.5 kg per drawer), a check on the tray capacity

L20. Screwfix: Essentials 964VN 350 mm runners; Metrol: Accuride DZ3832EC; IKEA: BESTÅ drawer runners

L21. NIST SP 500-252 / CLIR pub121: Care and Handling of CDs and DVDs (store upright, book style)

L22. Sony PS3 and Microsoft Xbox 360 S manuals: ventilation; IKEA UK: secure it

L23. Ideal Home: colour drenching; The Paint Shed: colour drenching with Farrow & Ball; Livingetc: sage green shades (Card Room Green, Treron, Sage Green, Green Smoke)

L24. Pontata: Card Room Green vs Little Greene Sage Green (approximate screen colours)

L25. Homebase and NC Tiles: Farrow & Ball Card Room Green No. 79 in Modern Eggshell and Estate Eggshell

L26. haart Medway: floor plans and listing photos for the house (Portsmouth Close)

L27. ConsoleMods: PS2 Component Video Out setting

L28. GOV.UK: Electrical safety, Approved Document P (2013 edition, for use in England): notifiable work is a new circuit, a replacement consumer unit, or an addition or alteration to a circuit in a special location (round a bath or shower); like-for-like replacements and additions to existing circuits elsewhere are not notifiable (gov.uk/government/publications/electrical-safety-approved-document-p)

L29. IET Electrical: Part P, England and Wales (notifiable and non-notifiable work); Planning Portal: Electrics, Building Regulations (non-notifiable work must still meet the regulations, BS 7671)